Maal Help

Your Warehouse. Under Control.

USER MANUAL

Business Owner

Owns the company account. Sees everything: operations, stock value, margins, receivables and profitability. Configures the company, users, approval rules and integrations, and makes final approvals.

Version 1.0 · 25 October 2026

For Maal Help 1.0

About this manual

Item	Details
Product	Maal Help 1.0: *Your Warehouse. Under Control.*
Manual	Business Owner User Manual
Role in the system	Business Owner
Version / date	1.0 · 25 October 2026
Screenshots	Captured from the running application with the fictional demo company "ABC Trading & Warehousing"
Demo account for this role	`owner@example.com`. Development/demo environment only. The password is provided by your administrator and is never printed in manuals.

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1 Introduction

Who this manual is for

This manual is for people with the **Business Owner** role in Maal Help. Owns the company account. Sees everything: operations, stock value, margins, receivables and profitability. Configures the company, users, approval rules and integrations, and makes final approvals.

Maal Help is a warehouse operating system: stock by warehouse, location, batch and owner on a permanent ledger, plus purchasing, sales and fulfilment, billing, reports and an AI Copilot that answers from your own data.

Your role can

- ✓ Everything in the company, including finance and settings
- ✓ Approve any request (the only role allowed to approve its own)
- ✓ Create users and custom roles

Your role cannot

- ✗ See other companies' data
- ✗ Edit posted stock history (corrections are new transactions)

Screens show the fictional demo company **ABC Trading & Warehousing**. Your company's names and numbers will differ. Menus show only what your role is allowed to use.

2 Access and navigation

Signing in

Maal Help runs in any modern browser on a computer, tablet or Android phone. Your company administrator creates your account and gives you a temporary password.

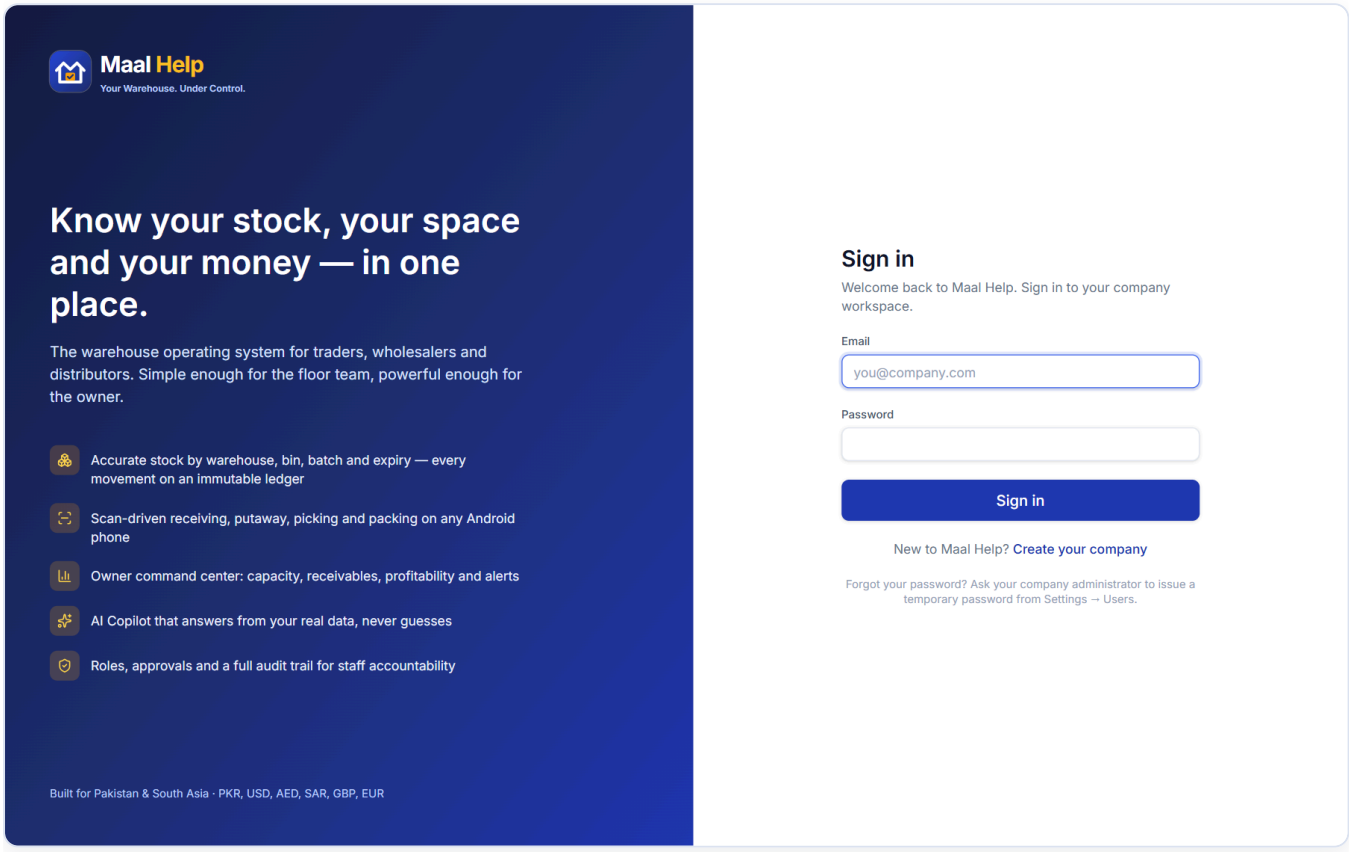


Figure 1. The Maal Help sign-in page.

1. Open the Maal Help address your company gave you.
2. Enter your work email and password, then select **Sign in**.
3. The first time, change your temporary password: **Settings** → **My profile** → **Change password** (at least 10 characters with letters and numbers).
4. Forgot your password? Ask your company administrator to issue a temporary one (**Settings** → **Users** → **Reset password**).

> After 8 wrong passwords the account is locked for a short time. Wait, then try again.

> Sign out on shared computers. Sessions also expire automatically.

Finding your way around

The left sidebar shows only the screens your role may use. Counts next to a menu item (for example Putaway 2) show open work.

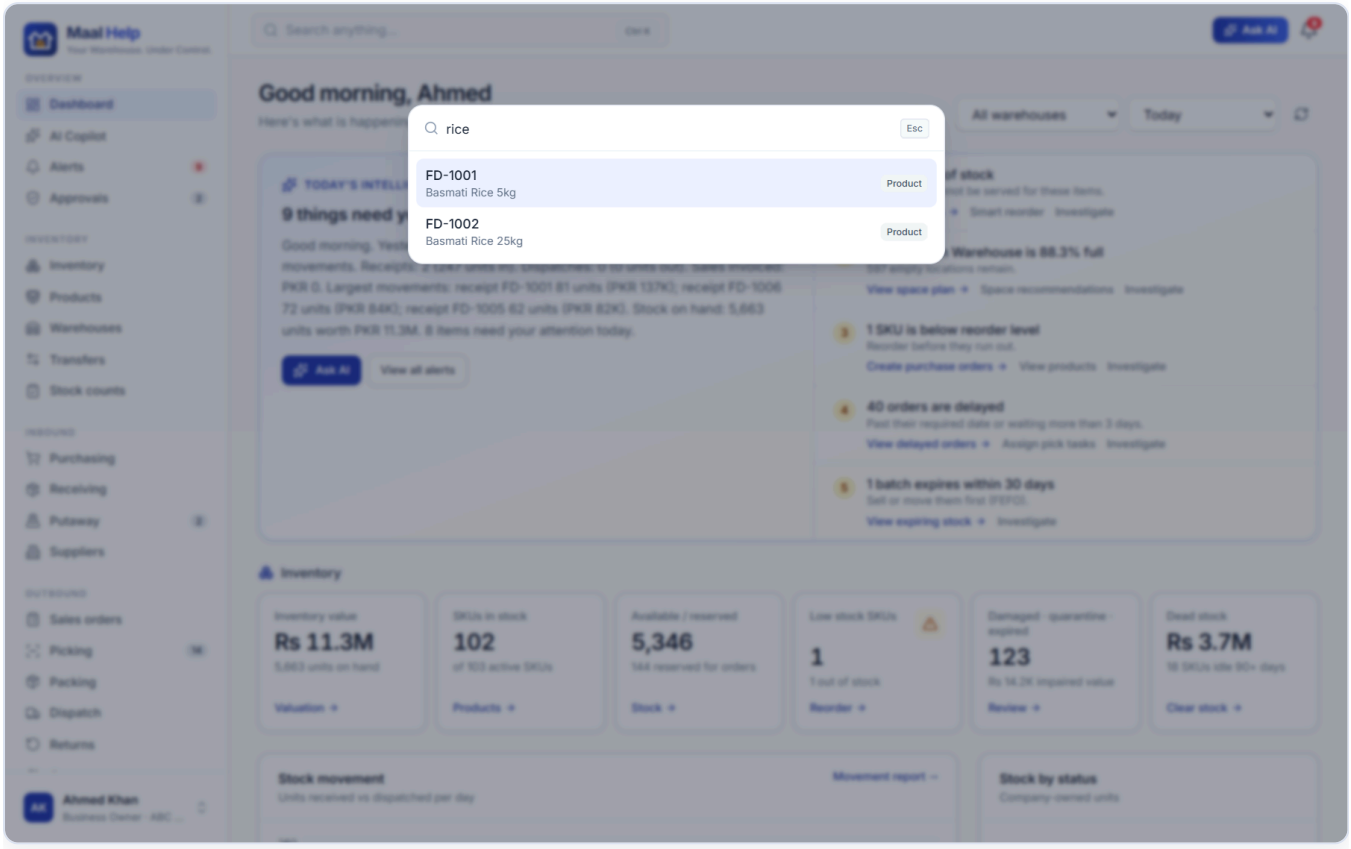


Figure 2. Press Ctrl + K anywhere to search products, orders, customers, locations and screens.

1. Use the **sidebar** to move between screens. Your name and role are at the bottom.
2. Use **Search anything...** at the top, or press **Ctrl + K**, then type a SKU, barcode, order number or name.
3. The **bell** opens your notifications. **Ask AI** opens the Copilot (if your role has it).
4. Tables support search, filters, sorting and paging. Click a row to open the record.

> If a screen or button you expect is missing, your role does not include that permission. Ask your administrator. The server enforces permissions, so hiding a menu is never the only control.

3 Your home screen

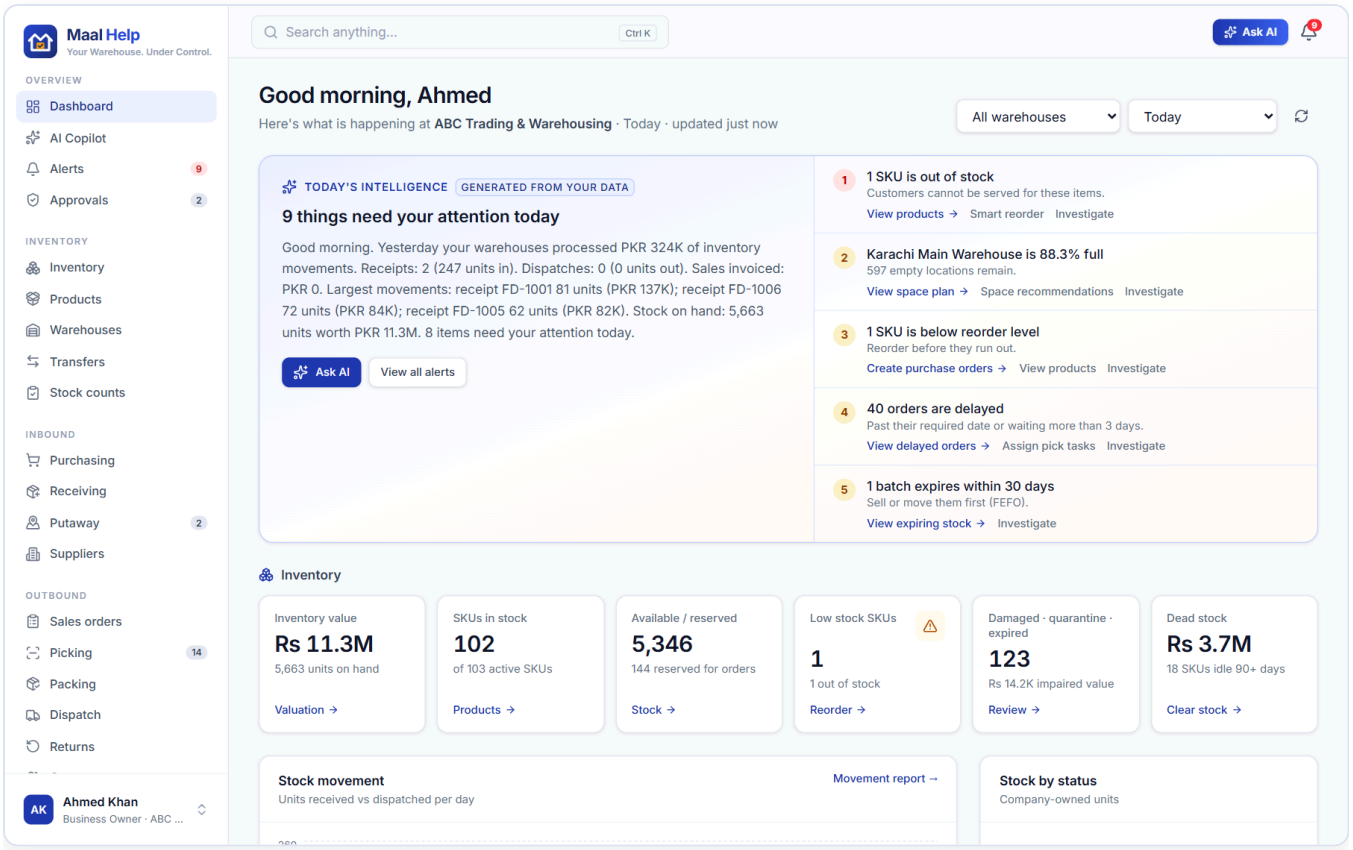


Figure 3. The owner command center: ranked attention items and KPIs.

- **Today's intelligence** ranks what needs your attention, for example out-of-stock SKUs, a warehouse nearly full, delayed orders or expiring batches. Each item has one-click actions.
- Filter the whole dashboard by **warehouse** and **period** at the top right.
- **Inventory** cards: inventory value, SKUs in stock, available/reserved, low stock, damaged/quarantine/expired, dead stock.
- Charts below show stock movement, stock by status, sales and receivables.

4 Features step by step

The dashboard on your phone

The owner dashboard adapts to a phone screen, so you can check the business anywhere.

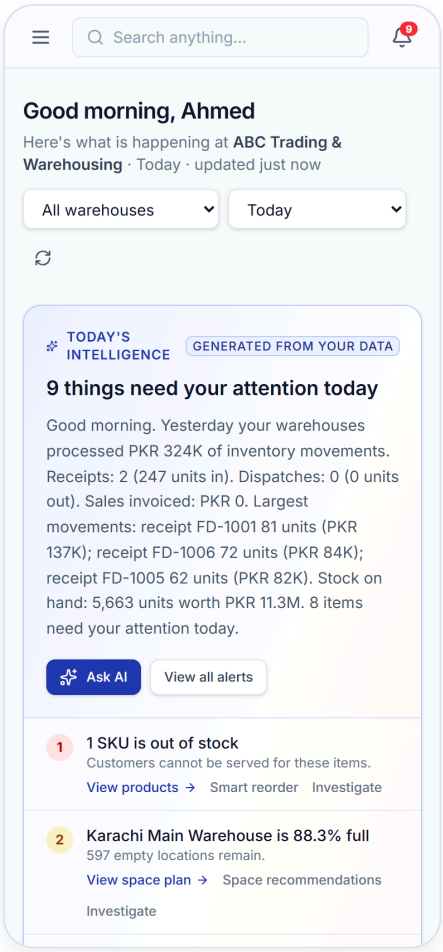


Figure 4. Owner dashboard on a phone.

1. Open Maal Help in your phone browser and sign in.
2. Scroll the attention items and KPIs; tap any item to drill down.

AI Copilot

Ask questions in plain English. The Copilot looks up facts with read-only tools limited to what your role may see, and shows its sources. It can recommend; you decide.

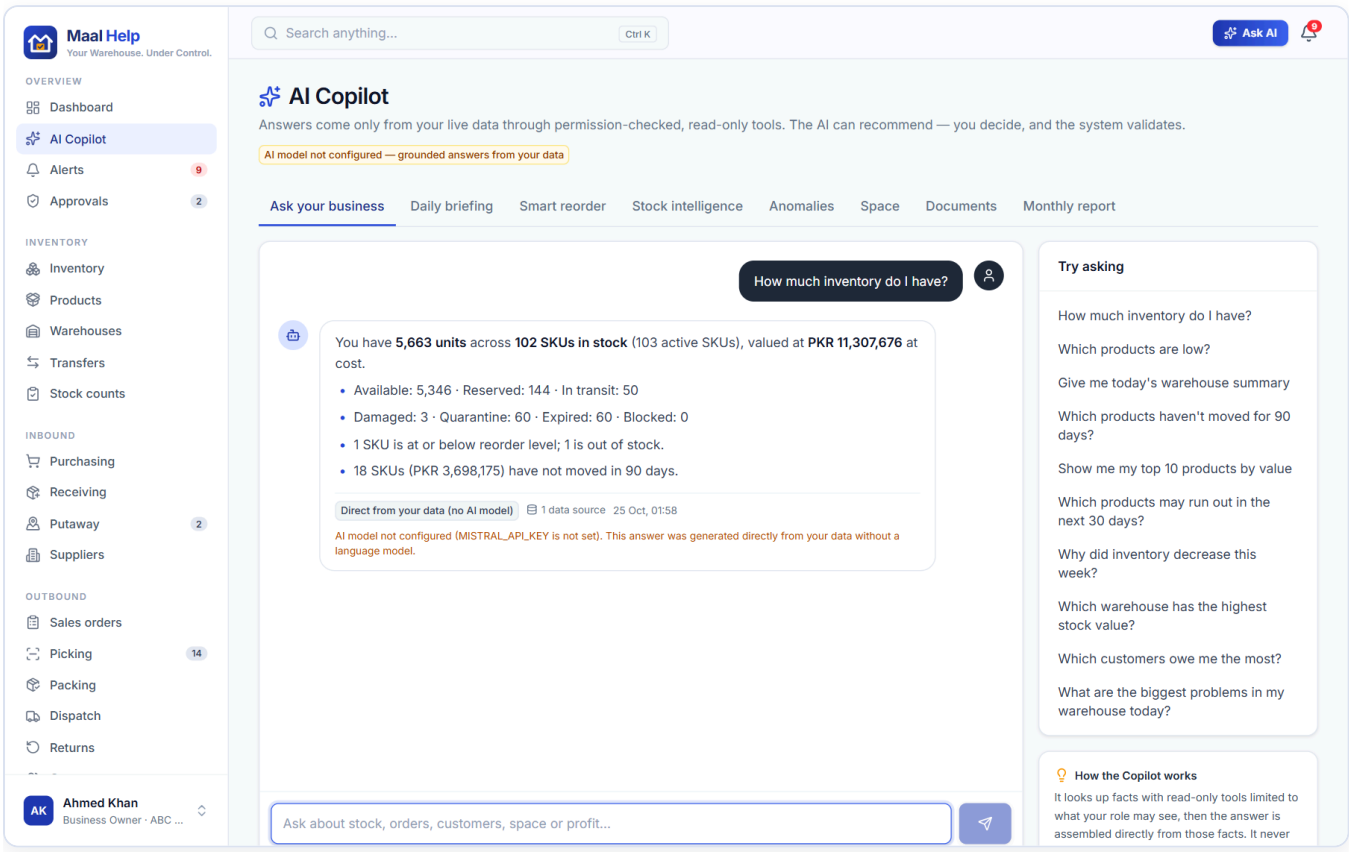


Figure 5. An answer built from live data, with its data source and mode shown.

1. Open **AI Copilot** (or select **Ask AI**).
2. Type a question, for example *How much inventory do I have?*, *Which products are low?* or *Which customers owe me the most?*, or tap a suggestion.
3. Check the badge under the answer: **Mistral AI · from your data** or **Direct from your data (no AI model)**. Open *data sources* to see what was used.
4. Other tabs: **Daily briefing**, **Smart reorder**, **Stock intelligence**, **Anomalies**, **Space**, **Documents**, **Monthly report**.

> The AI never changes stock, approves anything or posts financial entries. Suggested purchase orders open as drafts that a person must review and save.

> If your company has not configured the AI model, answers are assembled directly from your data and are clearly labelled.

> Anomalies are flags for review, never accusations. Write your findings when you mark one reviewed.

Approvals

Adjustments, purchase orders, count variances, transfers and expenses above your company's thresholds wait here. Nothing is posted until it is approved.

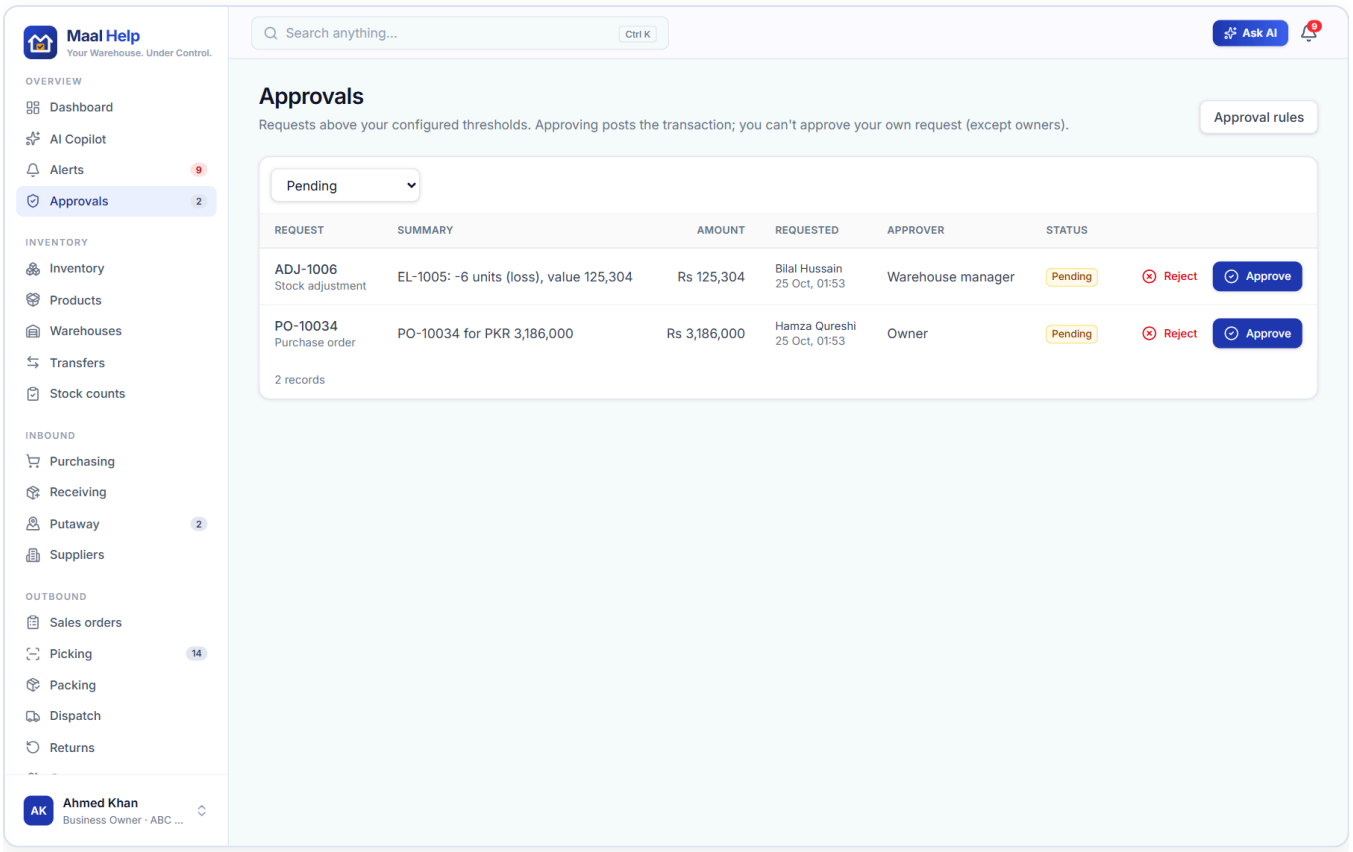


Figure 6. Pending approval requests with summary, amount and requester.

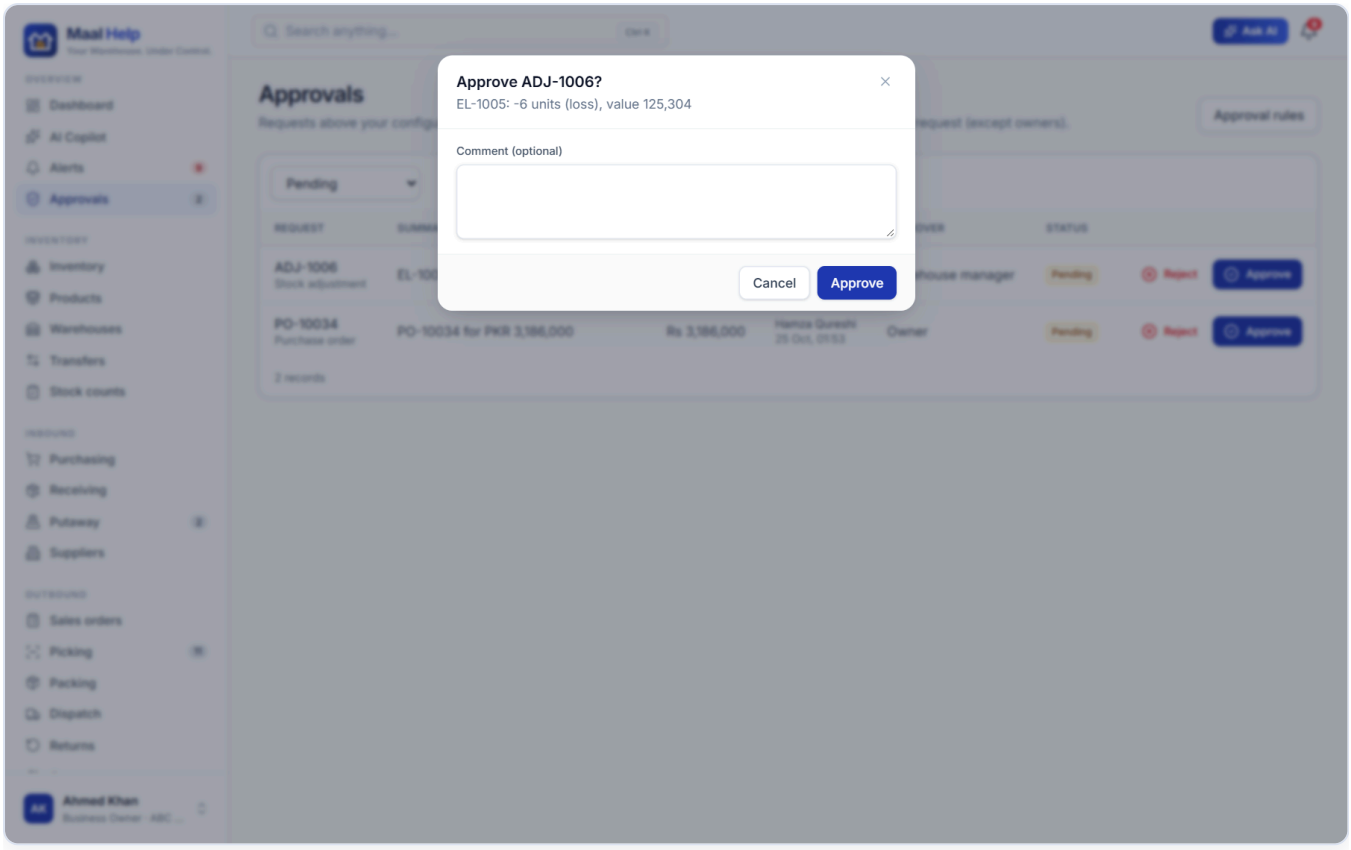


Figure 7. Approving a stock adjustment with an optional comment.

1. Open **Approvals**.
2. Read the summary and amount. Open the record if you need more detail.
3. Select **Approve** or **Reject**. Add a comment, which is kept in the audit trail.
4. Approving posts the underlying transaction (for example the stock adjustment) immediately.

> You cannot approve your own request; only the Business Owner is exempt. Thresholds are set in **Settings → Approval rules**.

Alert center

Alerts tell you what needs action: low or out-of-stock items, expiring batches, full warehouses, delayed orders and overdue payments. You see only alerts your role may act on.

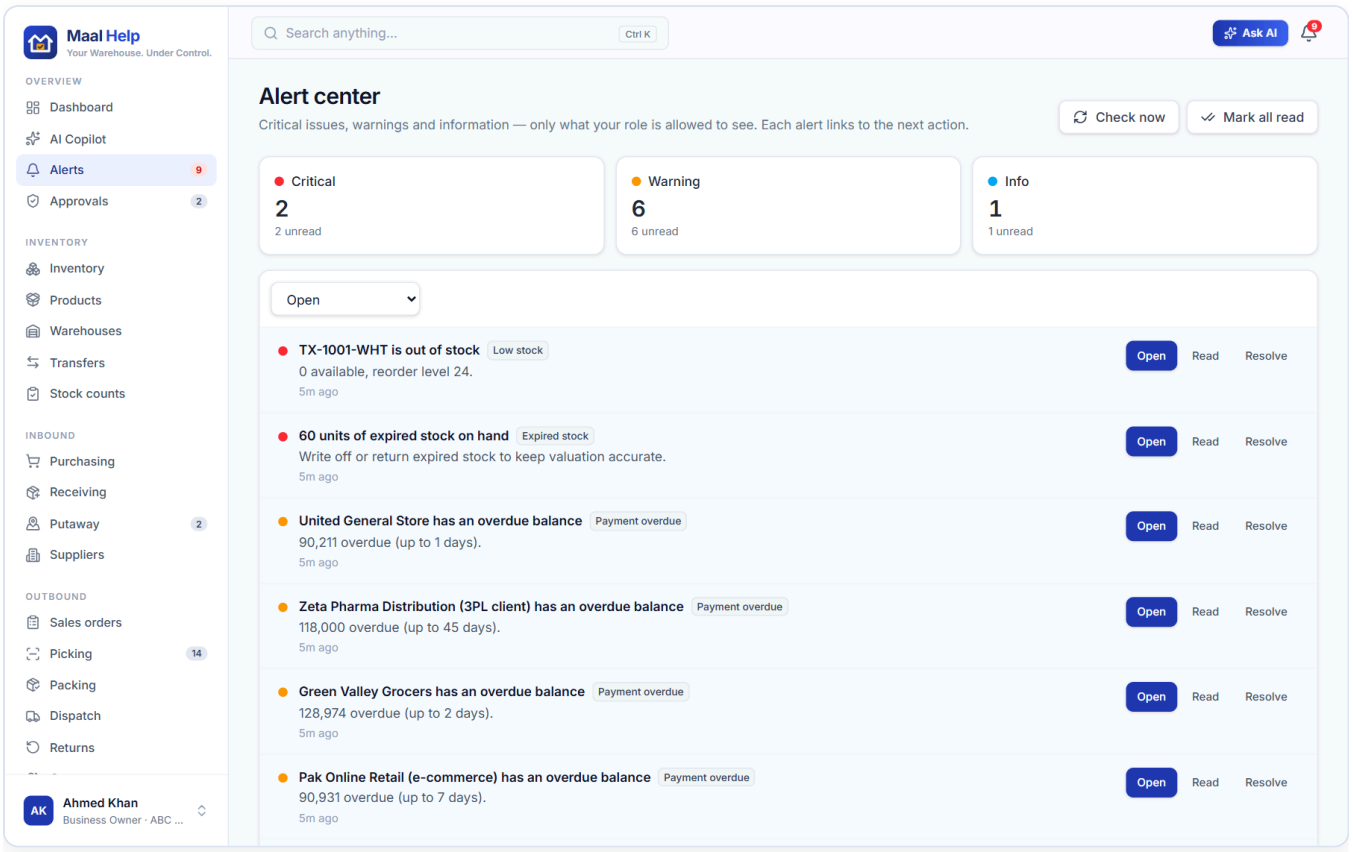


Figure 8. Alert center grouped by Critical, Warning and Info.

1. Open **Alerts** from the sidebar or the bell.
2. Filter by **Critical**, **Warning** or **Info**.
3. Use **Open** to go to the related record, **Read** to mark it seen, and **Resolve** when it is handled.
4. **Check now** re-evaluates alert conditions immediately (alerts are also checked automatically in the background).

Inventory: stock on hand and ledger

Every unit, by warehouse, location, batch, owner and status, backed by a ledger that nobody can edit or delete.

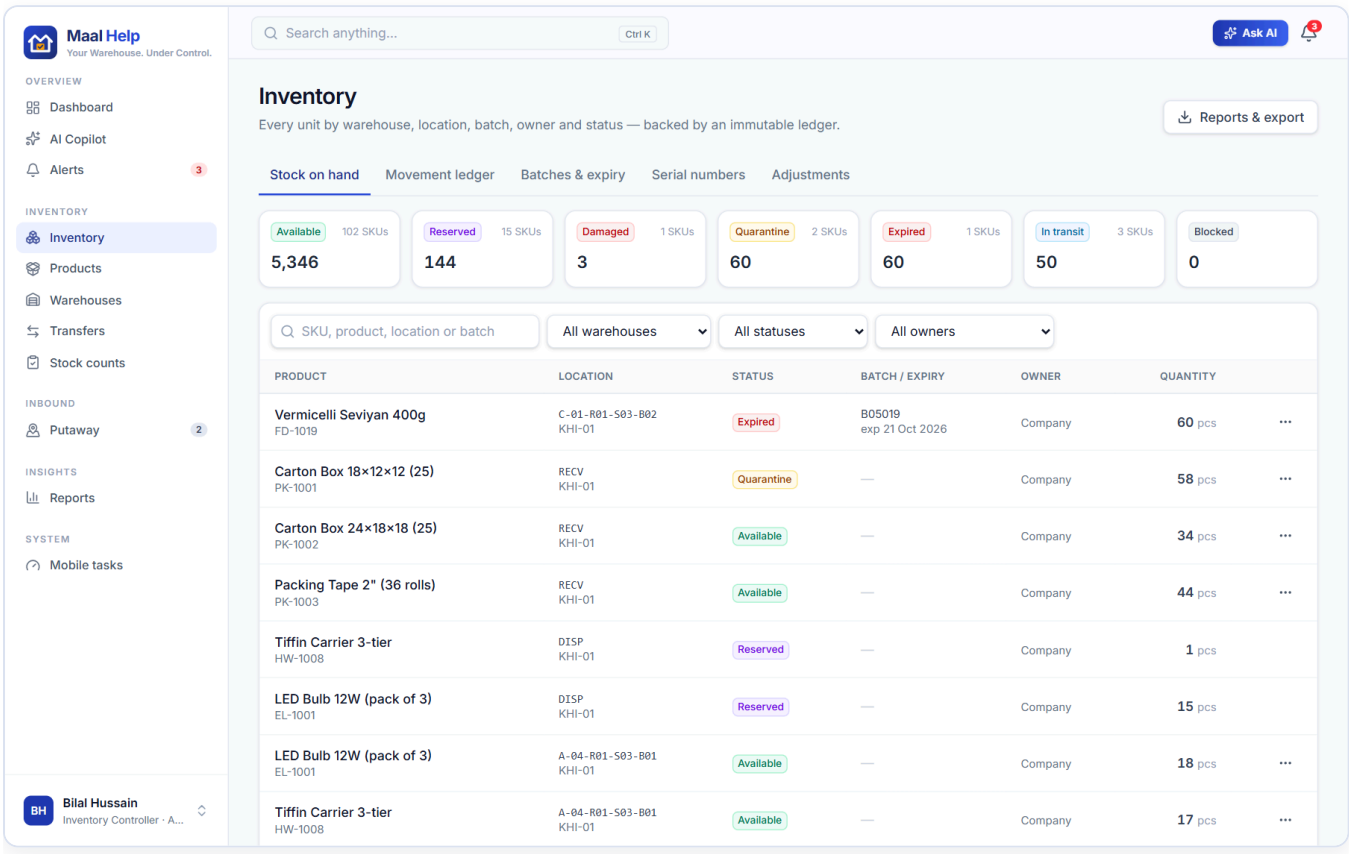


Figure 9. Stock on hand with status totals (Available, Reserved, Damaged, Quarantine, Expired, In transit, Blocked).

1. Open **Inventory**. Click a status card to filter, or search by product, SKU or location.
2. Tabs: **Stock on hand**, **Movement ledger** (every receipt, move, pick, dispatch, adjustment), **Batches & expiry**, **Serial numbers**, **Adjustments**.
3. Click a product to see its stock by location and its full movement history.
4. **Reports & export** opens the matching reports with Excel/CSV/PDF export.

> Stock can never go negative. Corrections are new transactions (adjustments, reversals), never edits.

> Roles without finance access do not see values or costs.

Warehouses and the space map

Warehouses contain zones, aisles, racks, shelves and bins, plus receiving and dispatch docks. Capacity is tracked in units, m^3, kg and pallets.

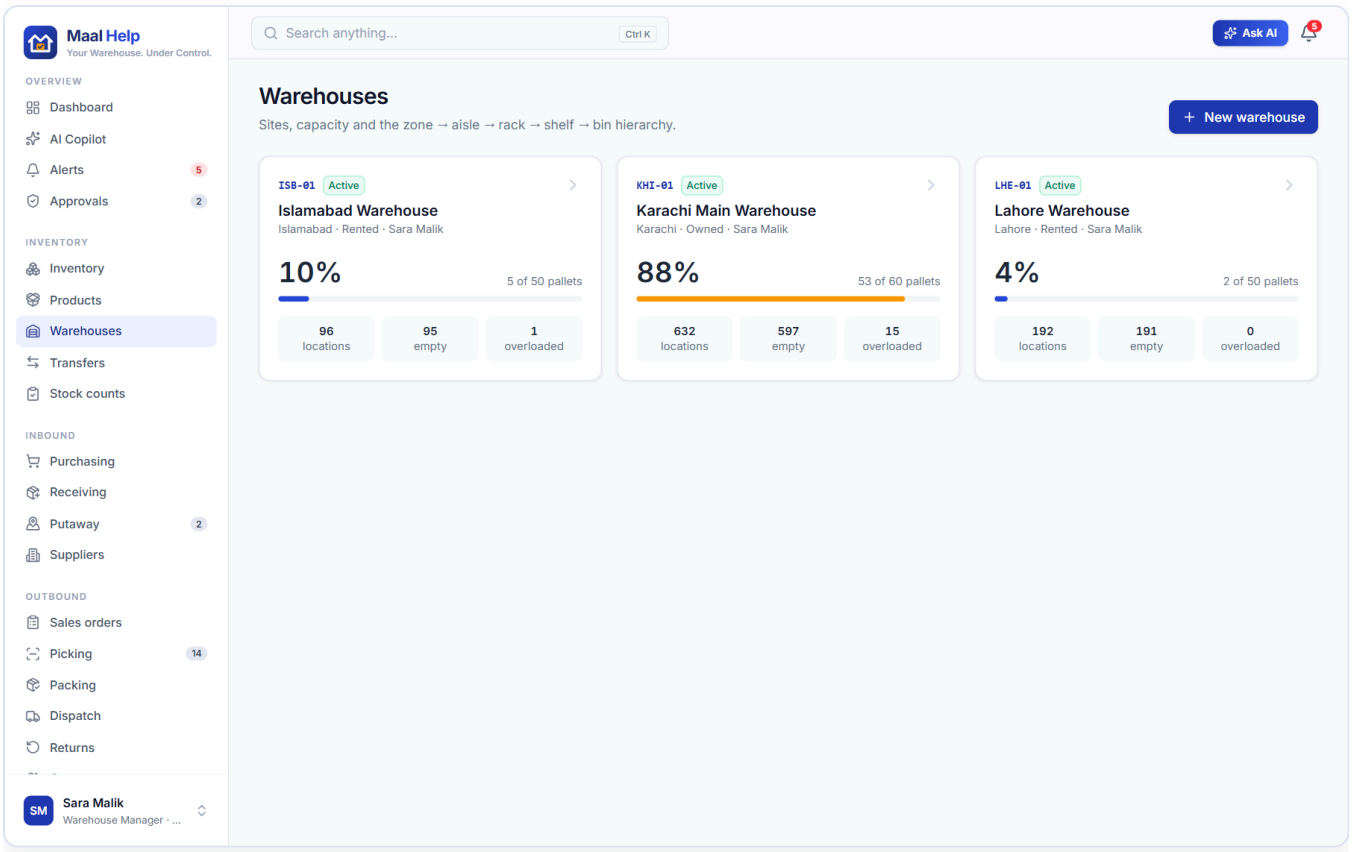


Figure 10. Warehouses with capacity and utilisation.

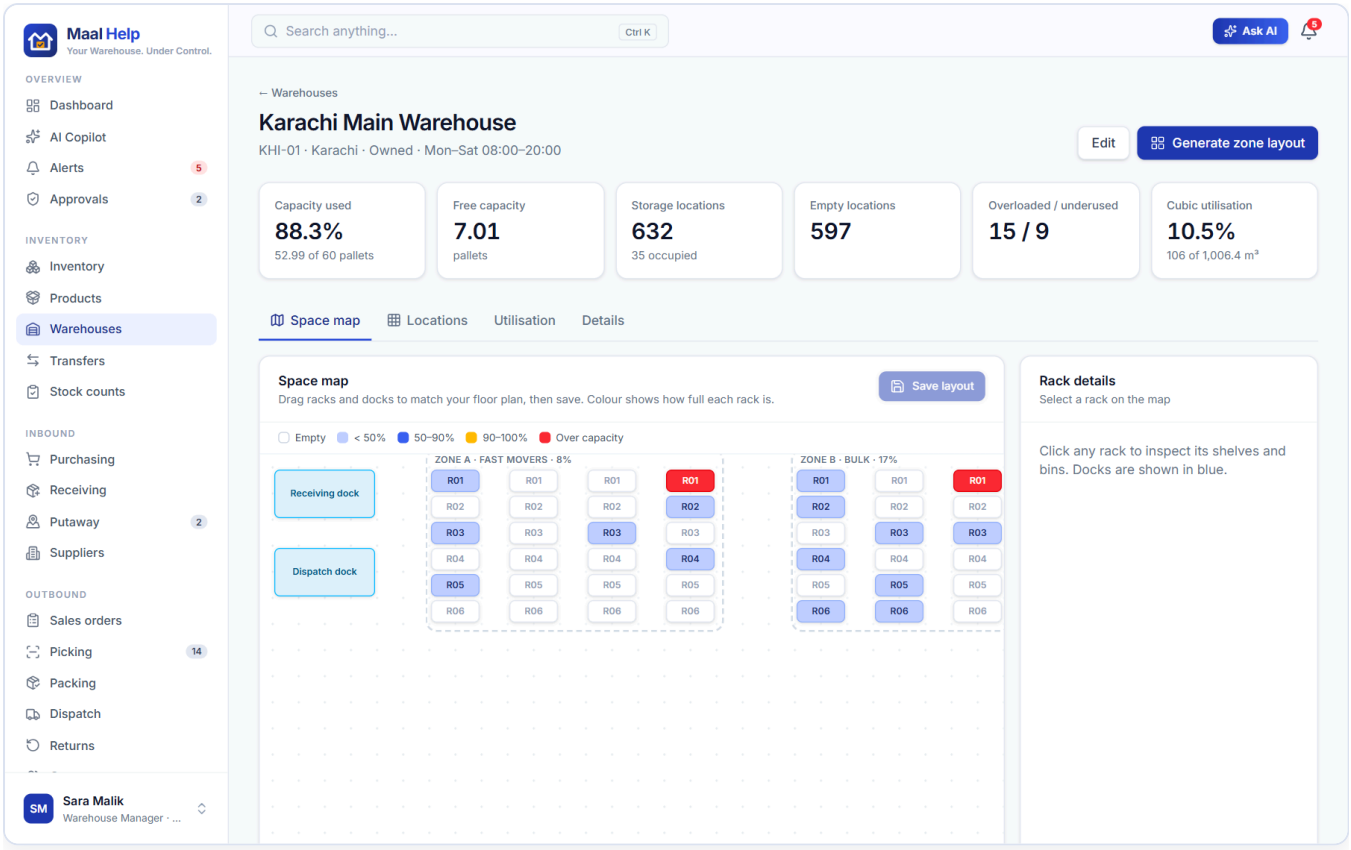


Figure 11. The space map: colour shows how full each rack is. Drag racks to match your floor plan.

1. Open **Warehouses** and choose a warehouse.
2. Read the KPI cards: capacity used, free capacity, storage and empty locations, over/under-used and cubic utilisation.
3. **Space map**: drag racks and docks to match the floor, then **Save layout**. Click a rack to inspect its shelves and bins.
4. Tabs **Locations**, **Utilisation** and **Details** list every bin with barcode and capacity.
5. **Generate zone layout** creates zones, racks, shelves and bins in one step for a new warehouse.

Sales orders

Create orders, check availability and reserve stock first-expiry-first-out. You cannot sell what is not available.

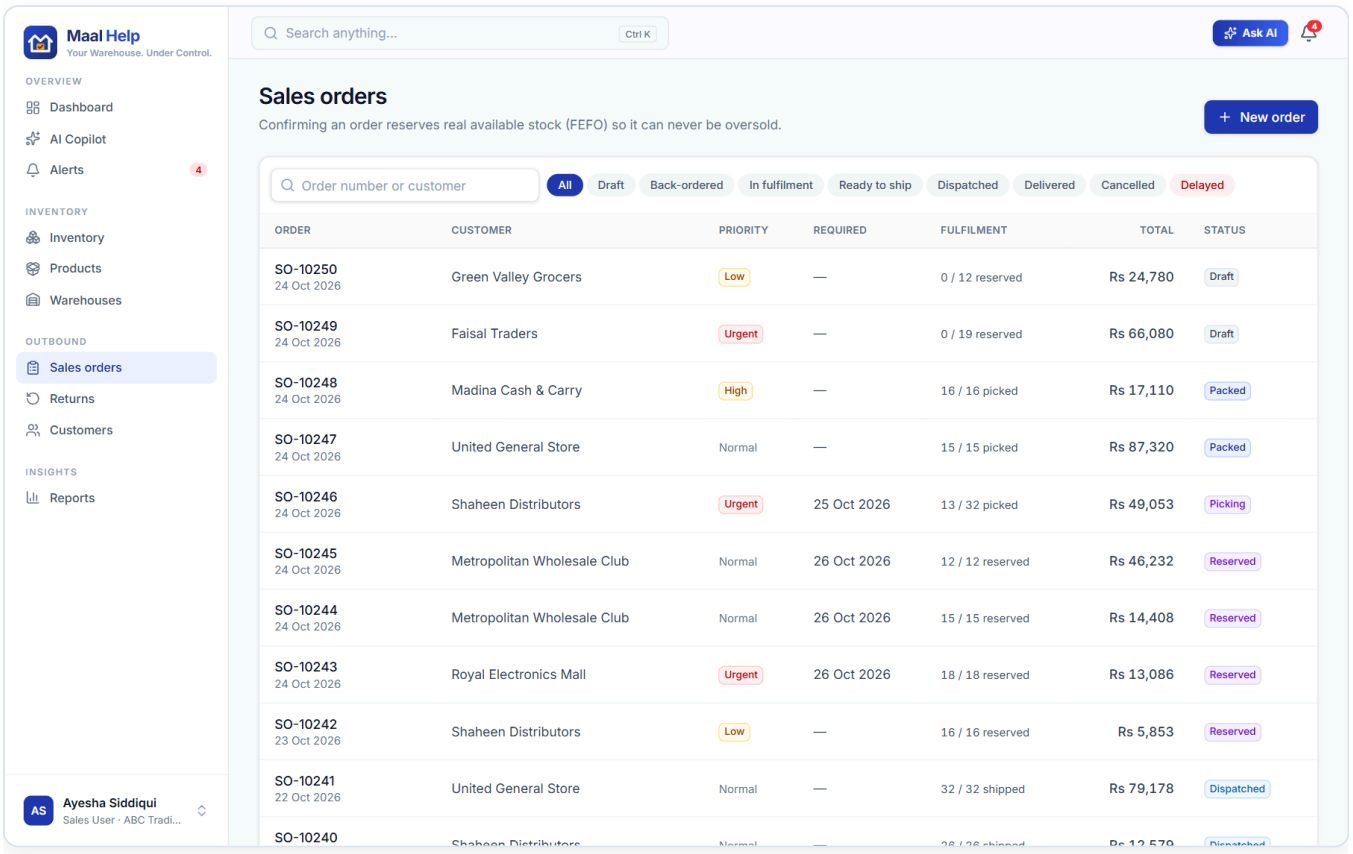


Figure 12. Sales orders by status.

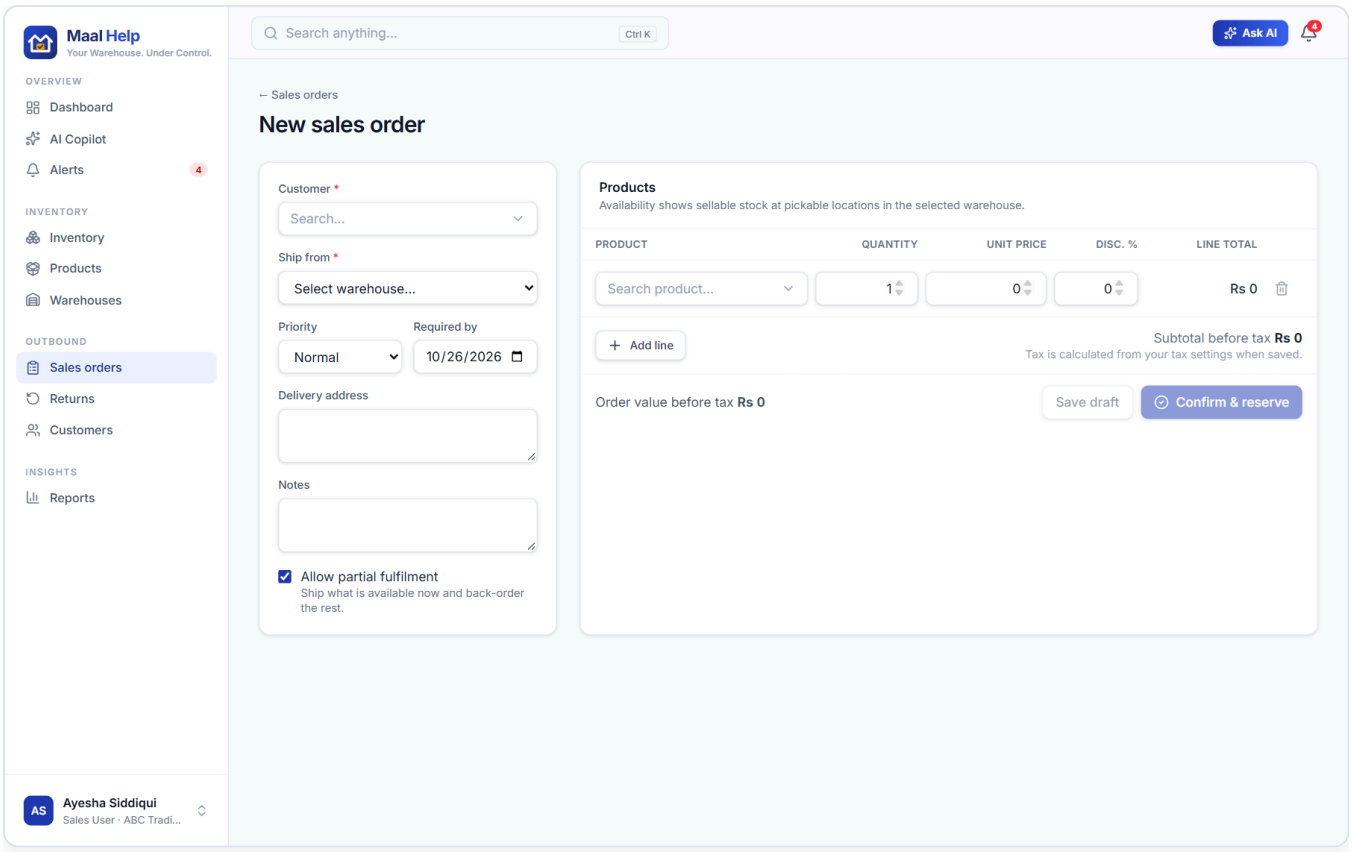


Figure 13. New sales order with availability per line.

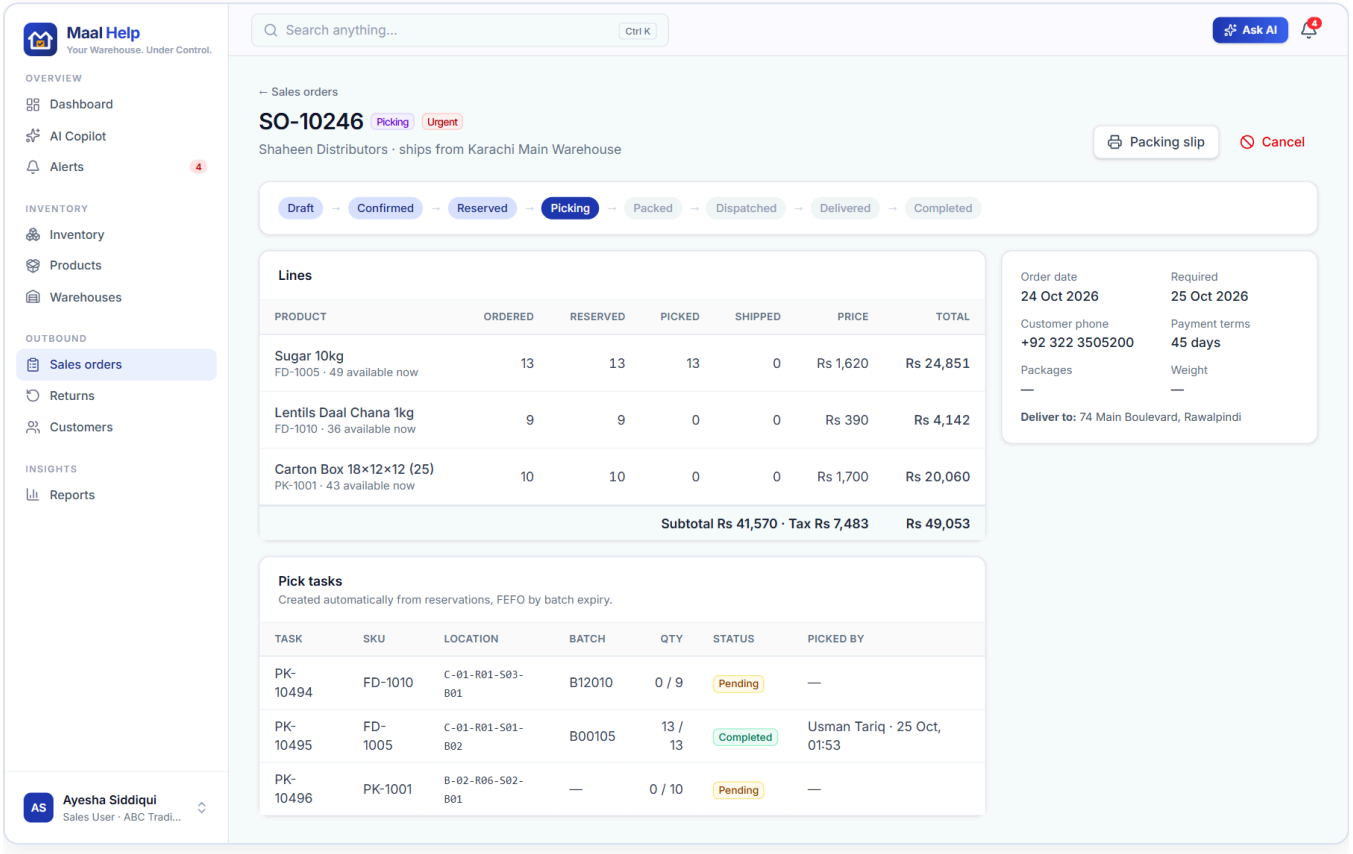


Figure 14. Order detail with the status path Draft → Confirmed → … → Completed.

1 **Sales orders → New**: choose customer, ship-from warehouse, priority and required date.

2. Add products. Availability shows sellable stock at pickable locations in that warehouse.
3. Tick **Allow partial fulfilment** to ship what is available and back-order the rest.
4. **Save draft**, or **Confirm & reserve**: stock is reserved (FEFO) and pick tasks are created.
5. Follow progress on the order: Picking → Packed → Dispatched → Delivered. Print the packing slip from the order.

> Confirmation is refused if the customer is over the credit limit.

> Cancelling before dispatch releases reserved stock.

Purchase orders

Draft → Submitted → Approved → Partially/Fully received → Closed. Large orders route to the owner for approval.

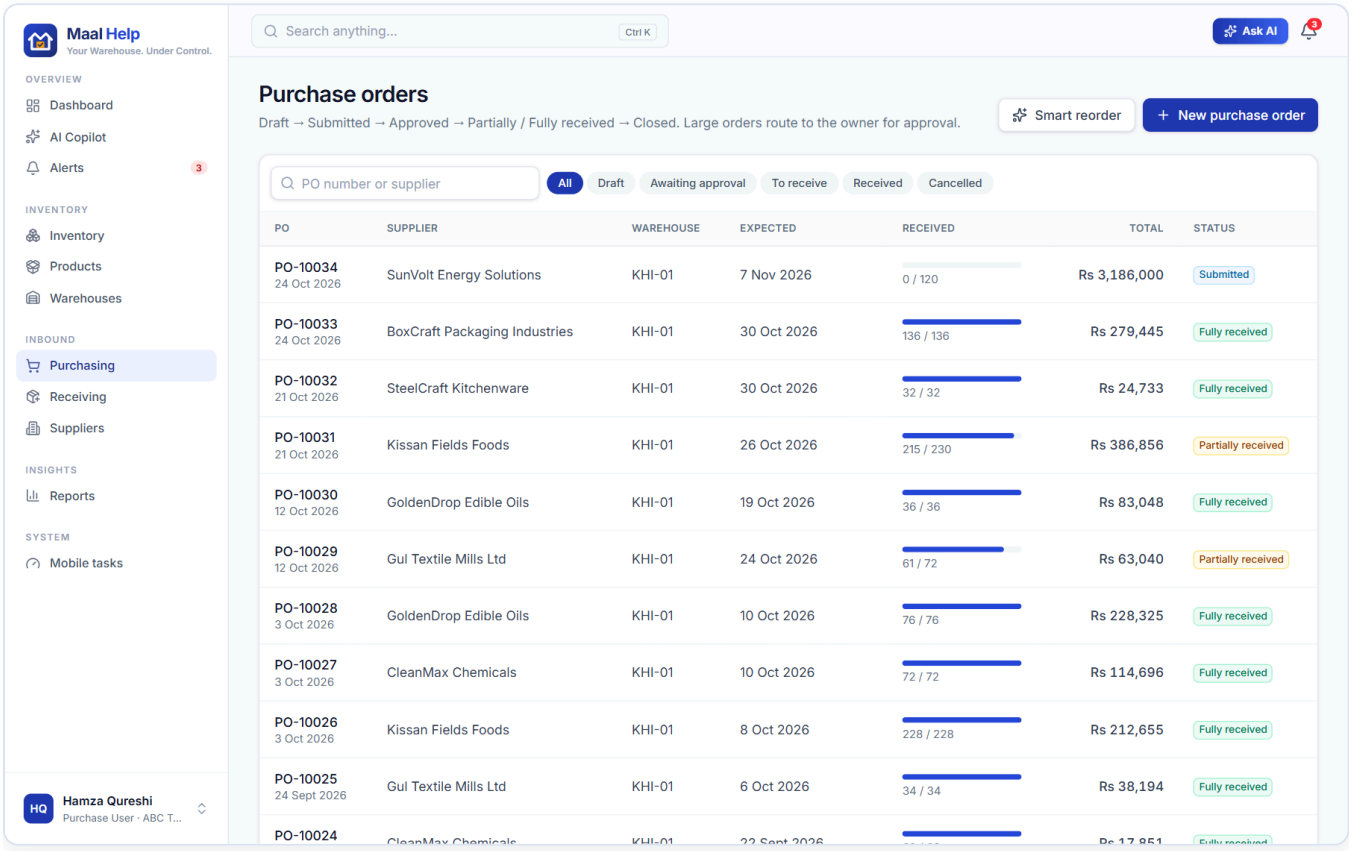


Figure 15. Purchase orders by status.

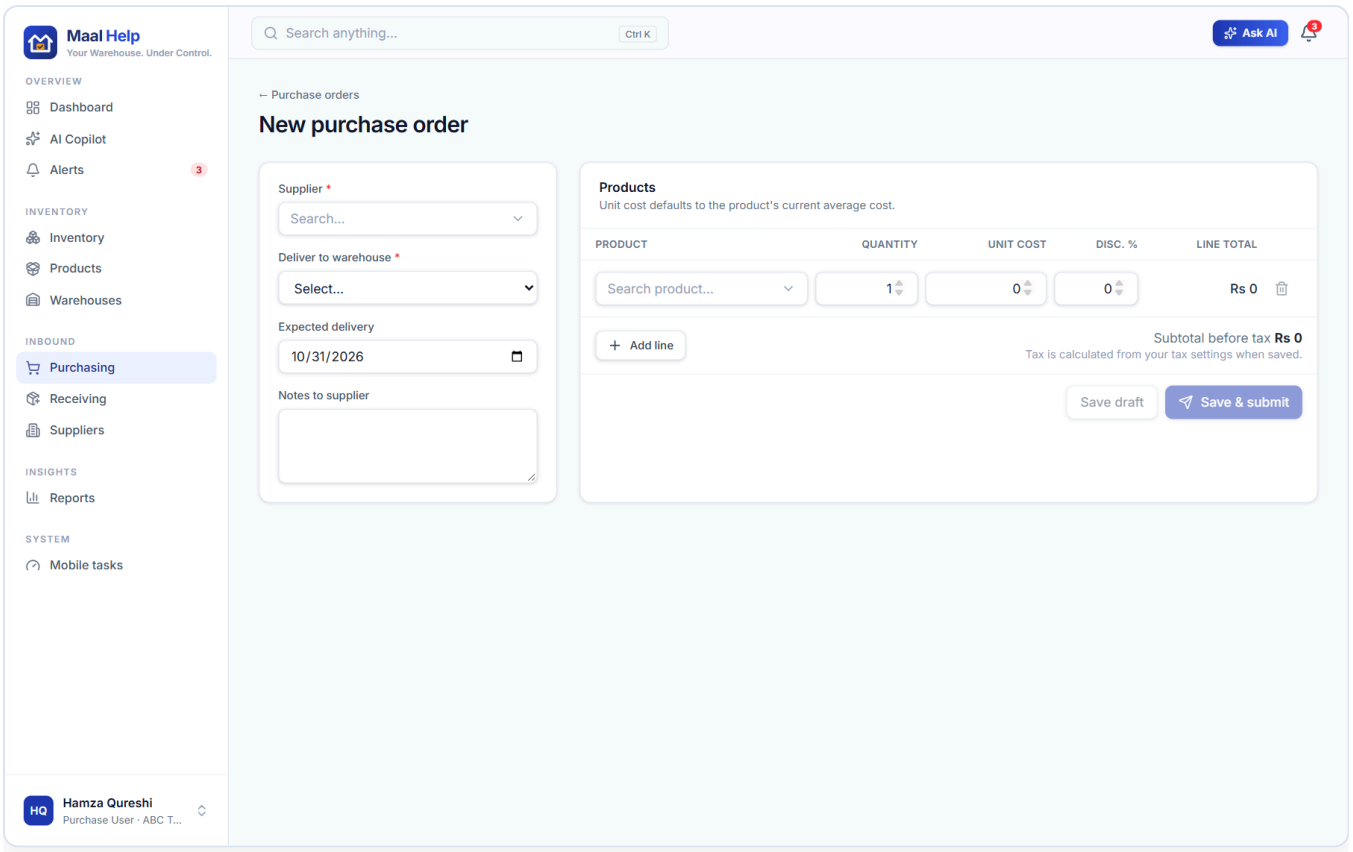


Figure 16. Creating a purchase order.

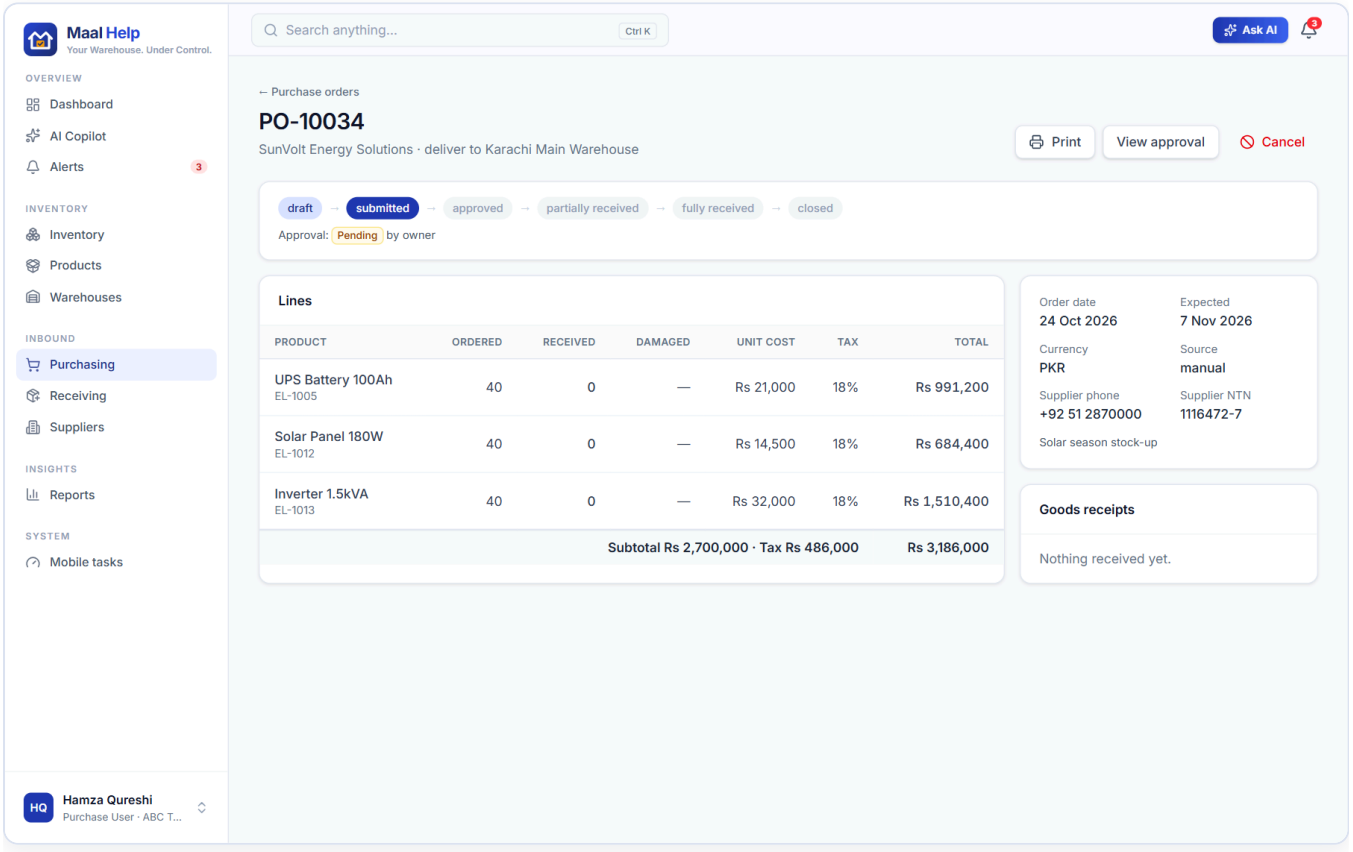


Figure 17. A purchase order with lines, receipts and status.

1. **Purchasing → New purchase order**: choose the supplier and delivery warehouse, and an expected delivery date.
2. Add lines (search product). Unit cost defaults to the current average cost.
3. **Save draft** or **Save & submit**. Orders above the threshold wait for approval.
4. Once approved, the order appears for receiving. Track received quantities on the order.
5. **Smart reorder** suggests what to buy from demand, lead time and stock on order. You review and create drafts.

Invoices, bills, payments and aging

Invoices are issued automatically at dispatch; supplier bills on goods receipt.

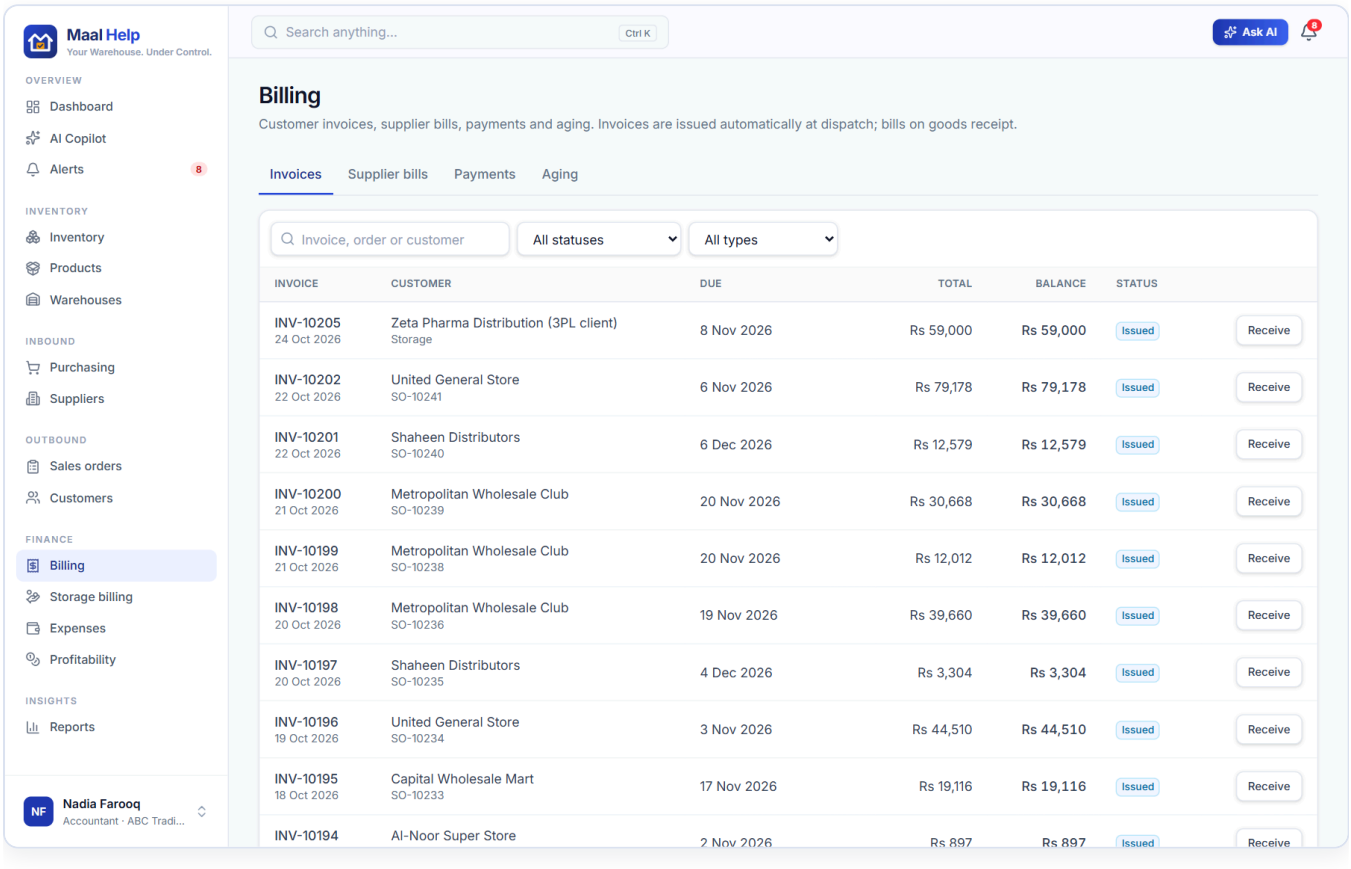


Figure 18. Billing: Invoices, Supplier bills, Payments, Aging.

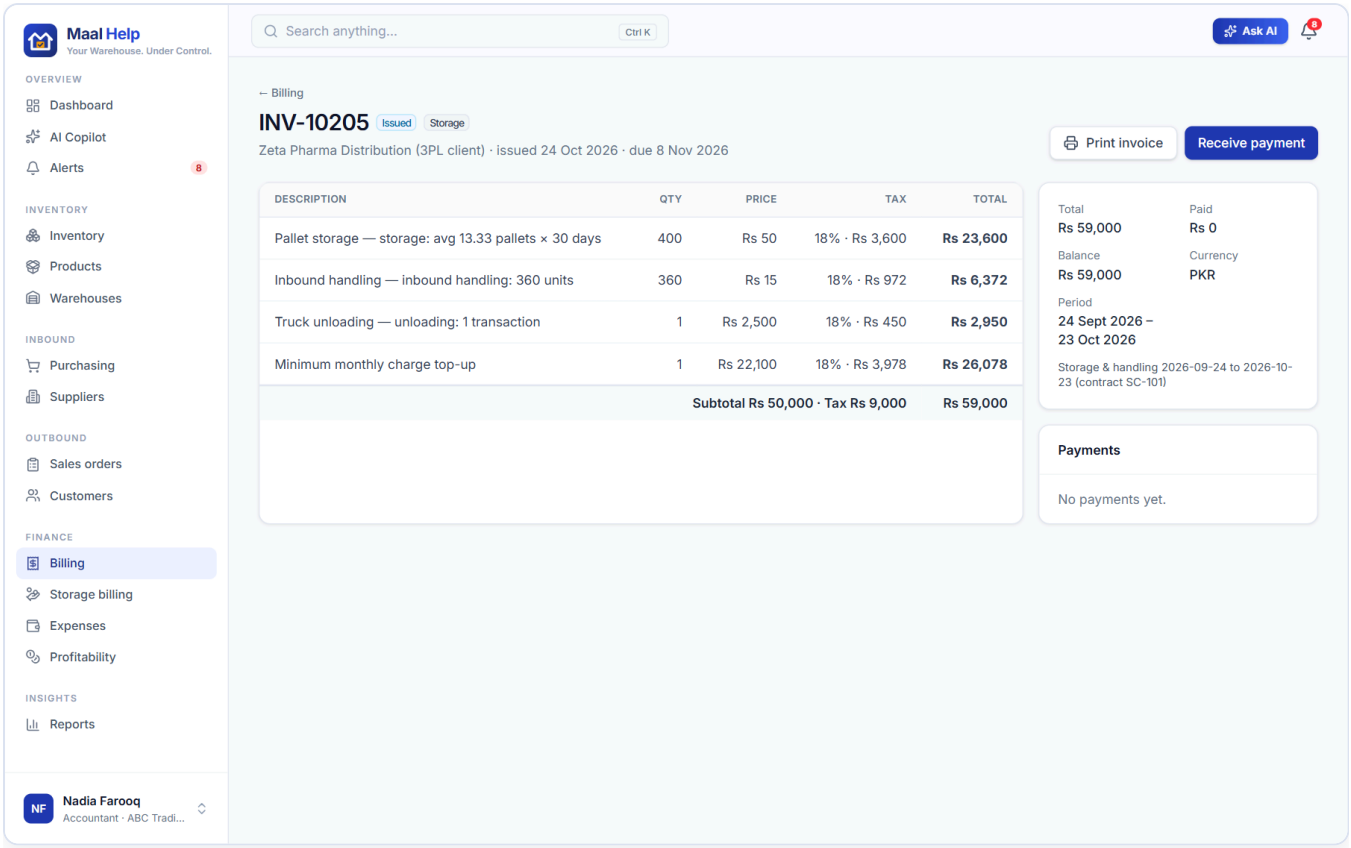


Figure 19. An invoice with lines, tax and payments.

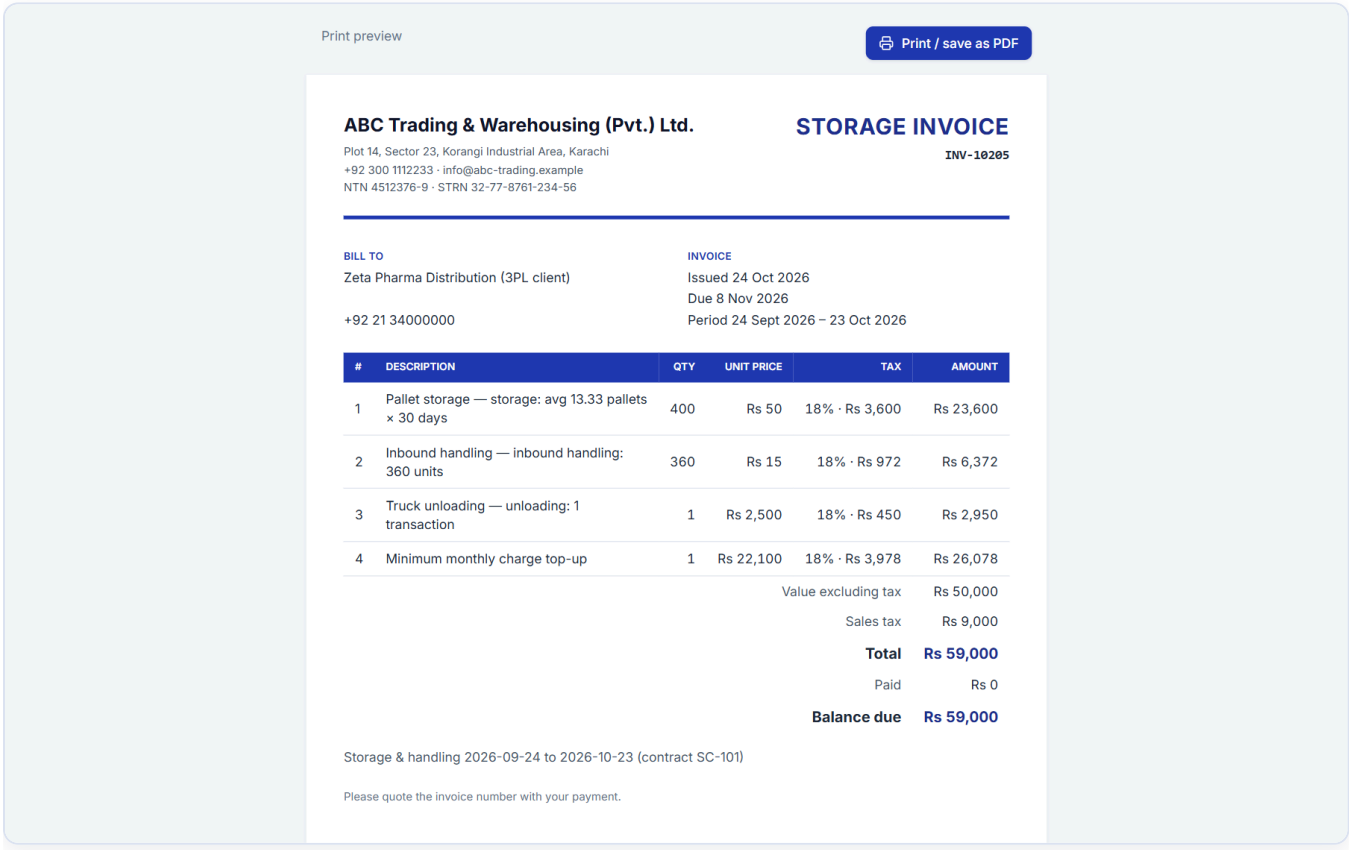


Figure 20. Printable invoice on the company letterhead.

1 Open **Billing**. Tabs: **Invoices**, **Supplier bills**, **Payments**, **Aging**.

2. Select **Receive** on an invoice to record a customer payment (method, amount, reference). Part payments are allowed.
3. Record supplier payments from **Supplier bills**.
4. Use **Aging** to see receivables and payables by days overdue.
5. Open an invoice and use print to produce a PDF or paper copy.

> FBR e-invoicing is not integrated in this version. Check your obligations with your tax adviser.

Storage billing (3PL)

If you rent warehouse space, charges are calculated from the ledger: pallets, boxes, m³, bins, kg or area per day, plus handling fees.

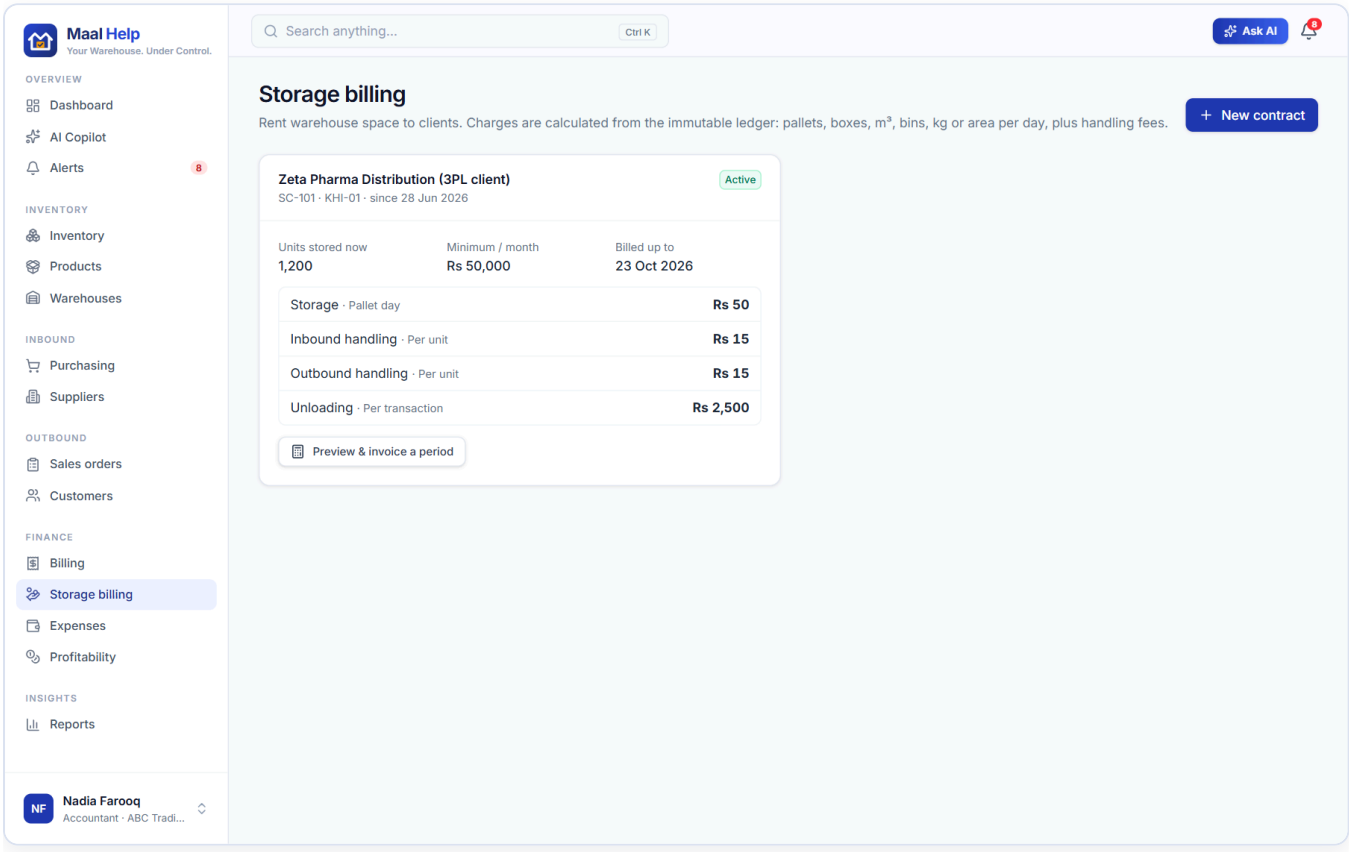


Figure 21. A storage contract for a 3PL client.

1. **Storage billing → New contract**: client, warehouse, start date, rates (storage basis and price; inbound/outbound handling; picking, packing, loading/unloading; minimum monthly charge).
2. Each period, choose **Preview & invoice a period** to check the calculation, then issue the invoice.
3. The invoice lists each charge with its quantity and rate.

Profitability

Estimated management view: revenue from invoices, cost of goods from the ledger, operating costs from expenses and freight.

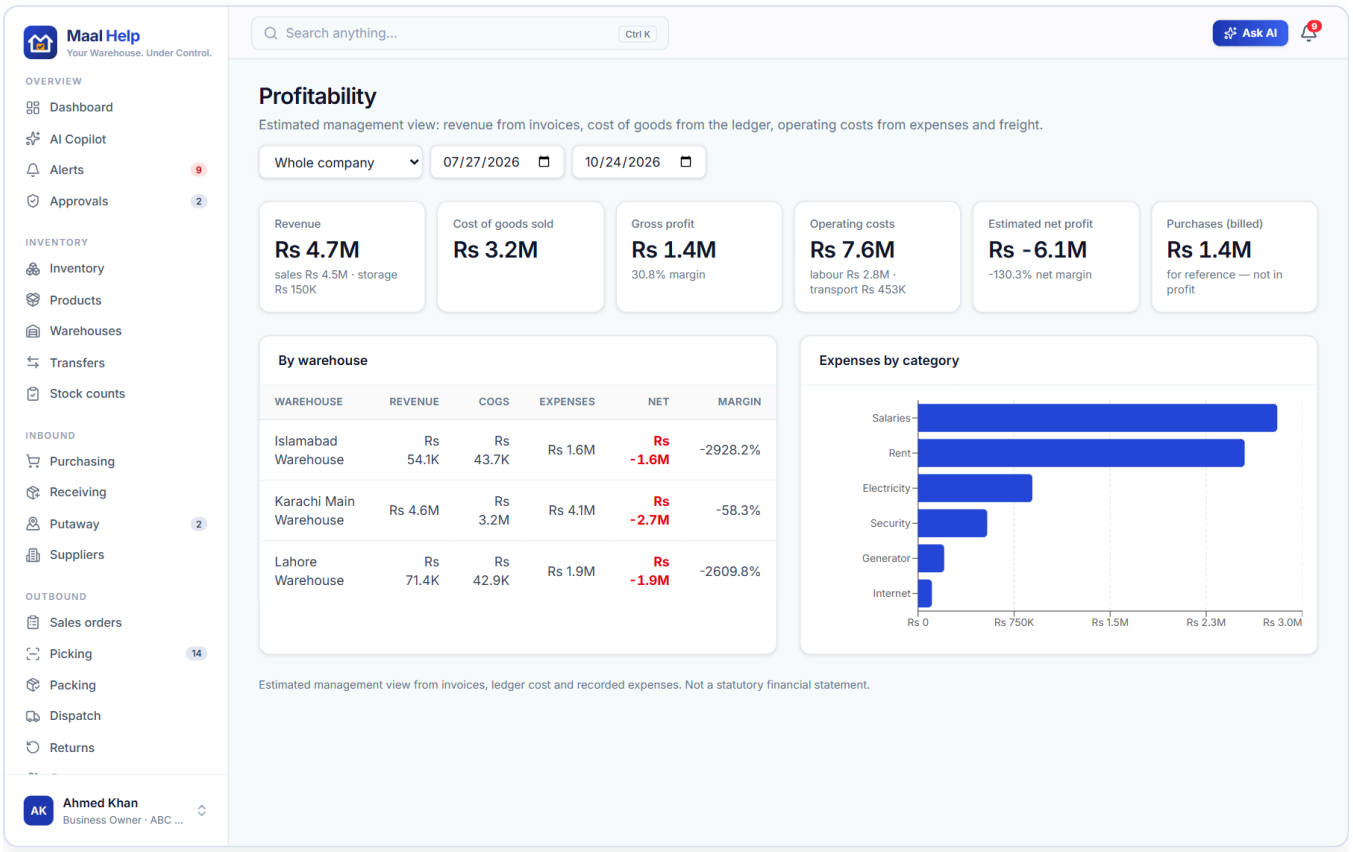


Figure 22. Profitability by warehouse and expenses by category.

1. Open **Profitability** and choose the period and warehouse.
2. Compare revenue, COGS, expenses, net and margin by warehouse.

> This is an estimate for decisions, not a statutory financial statement.

Reports and exports

35 reports in five groups: Inventory, Warehouse, Sales, Purchasing and Financial. Every report supports filters, search, sorting, paging, Excel/CSV/PDF export and printing.

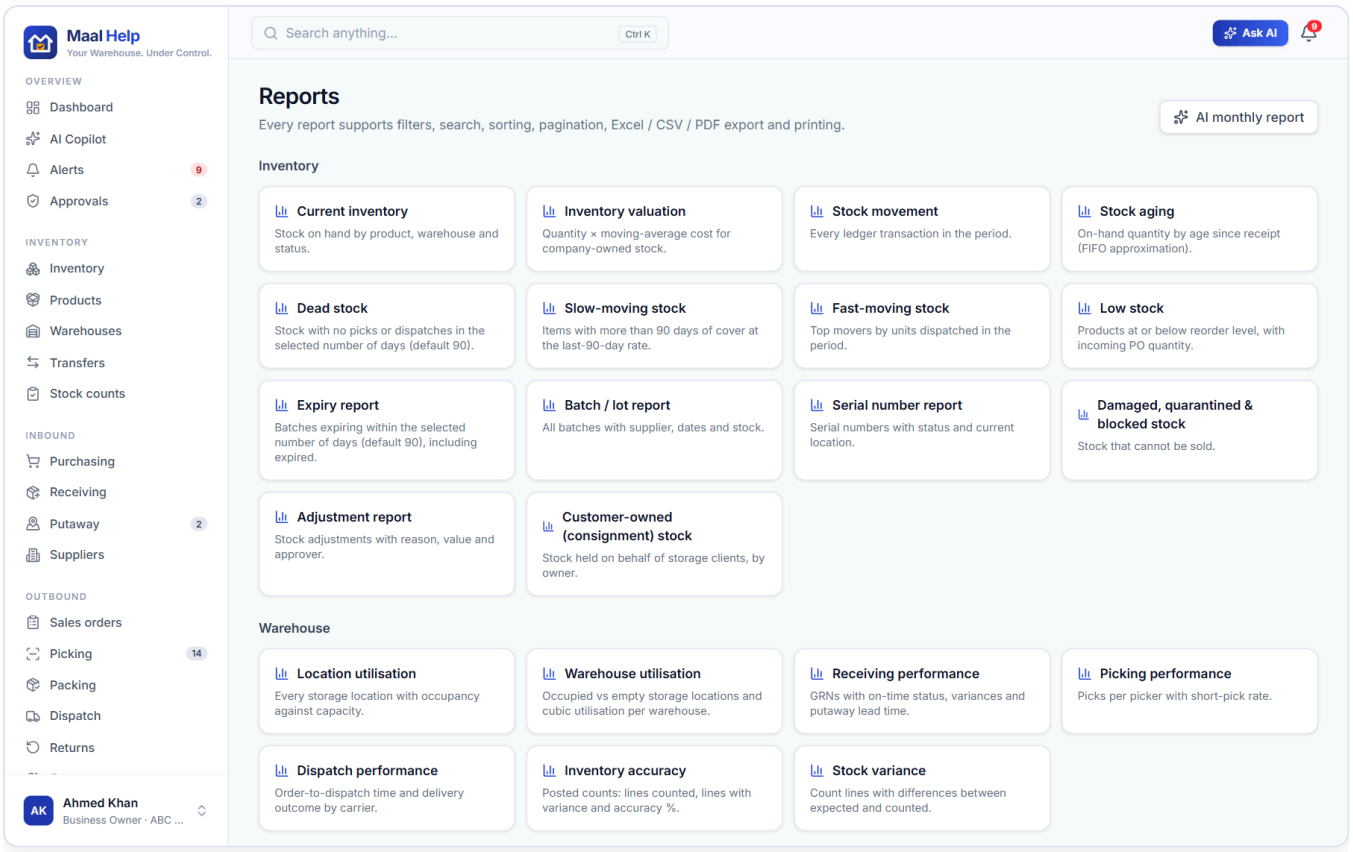


Figure 23. The report library.

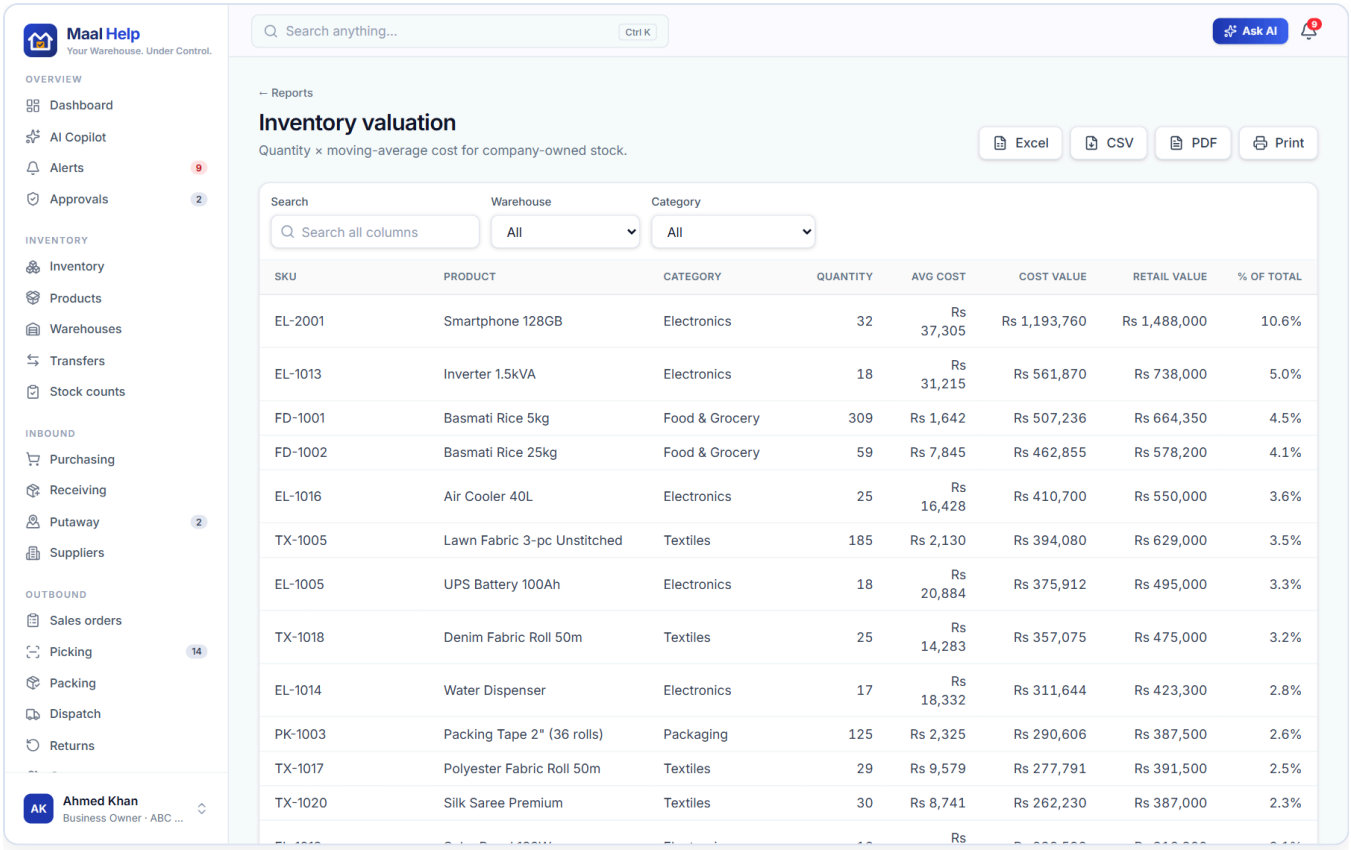


Figure 24. Inventory valuation with filters and export.

1. Open **Reports** and choose a report. You see only reports your role may view.
2. Set filters (dates, warehouse, product, customer…) and search or sort the table.
3. Export with **Excel**, **CSV** or **PDF**, or print. PDFs carry the Maal Help letterhead.
4. **AI monthly report** gives a written business summary for a month.

Audit trail

Append-only record of every important action: who, what, old and new values, IP address, device and time. It cannot be edited or deleted.

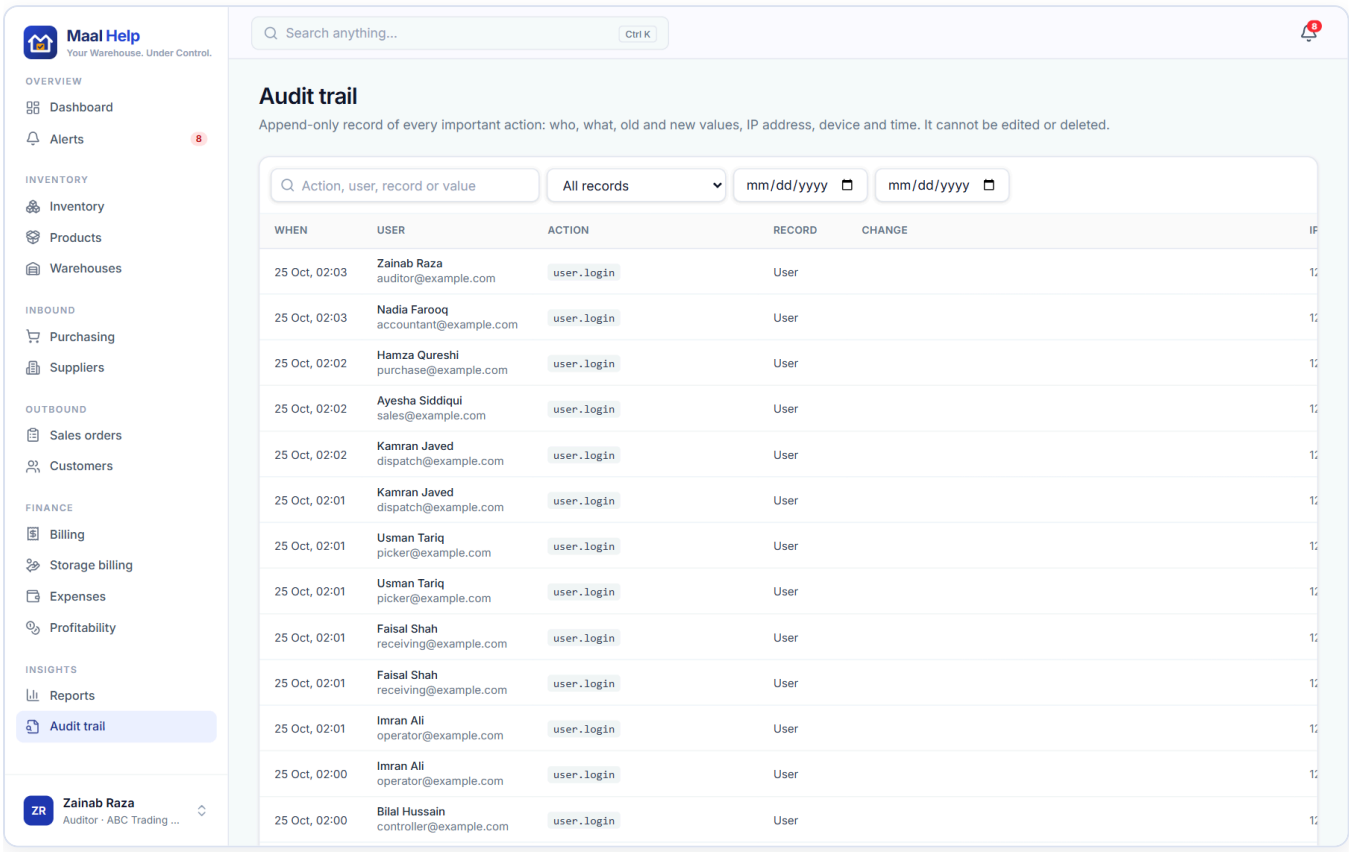


Figure 25. Audit trail with user, action, record and change.

1. Open **Audit trail**. Filter by user, action, record type or date.
2. Open an entry to see old and new values.

Company, tax and currency

Details printed on invoices, GRNs and purchase orders, and the tax engine’s rates.

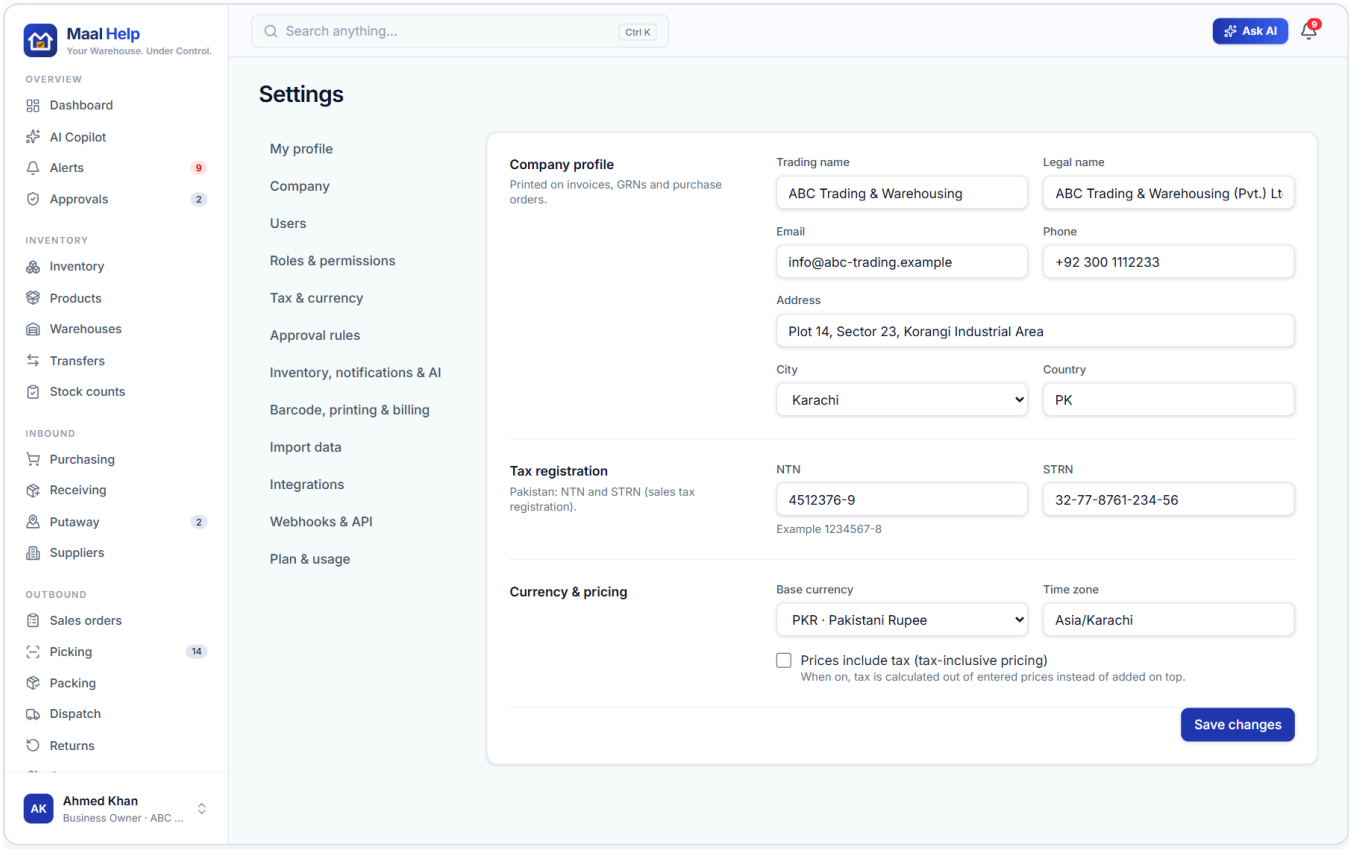


Figure 26. Company profile, tax registration and currency.

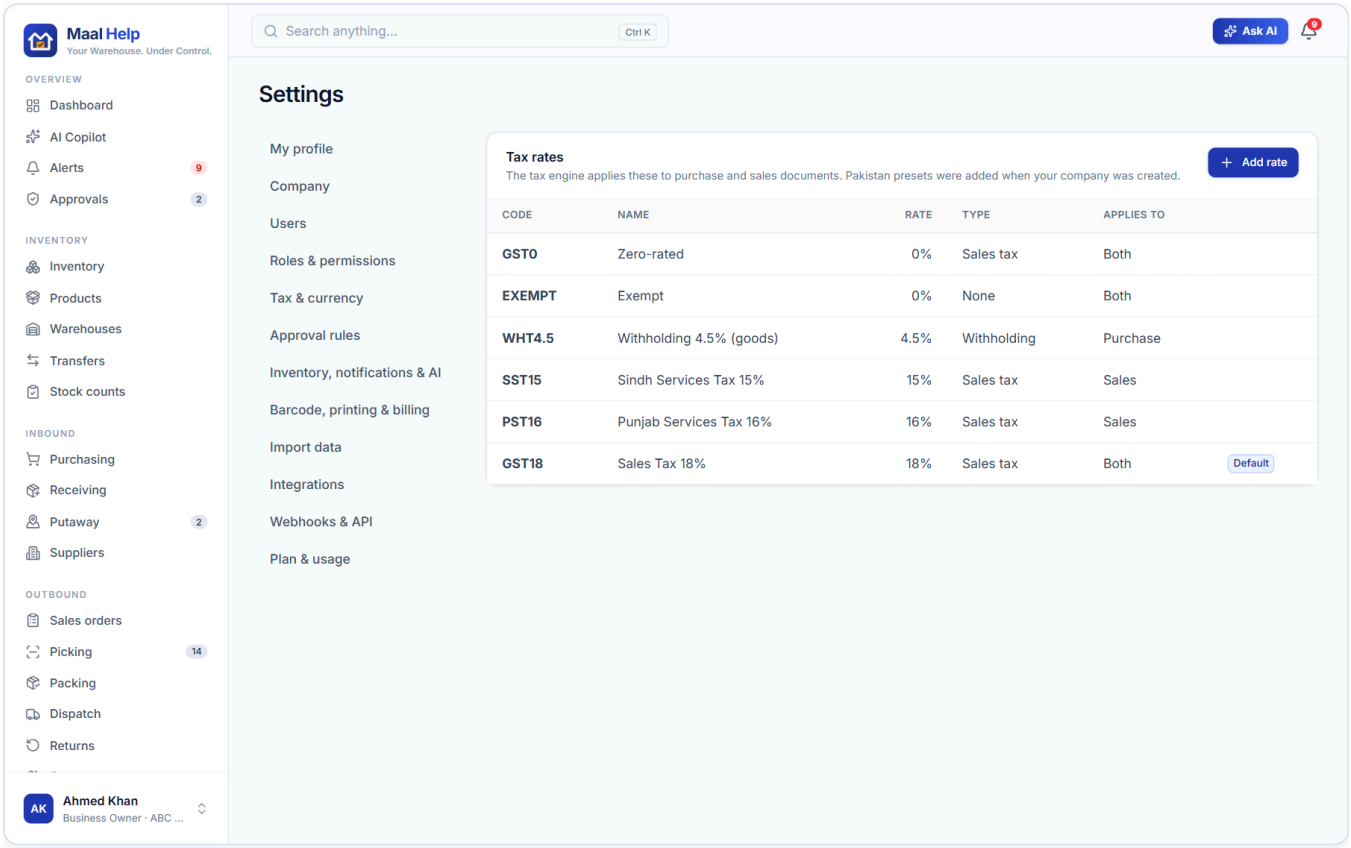


Figure 27. Tax rates (Pakistan presets added automatically).

1. **Settings → Company**: trading and legal name, contact details, address, city, NTN and STRN, base currency, time zone, tax-inclusive pricing.
2. **Settings → Tax & currency**: add or edit tax rates (code, name, rate, type, applies to).

Users and roles

Each person gets a role. Floor roles see the simplified mobile app.

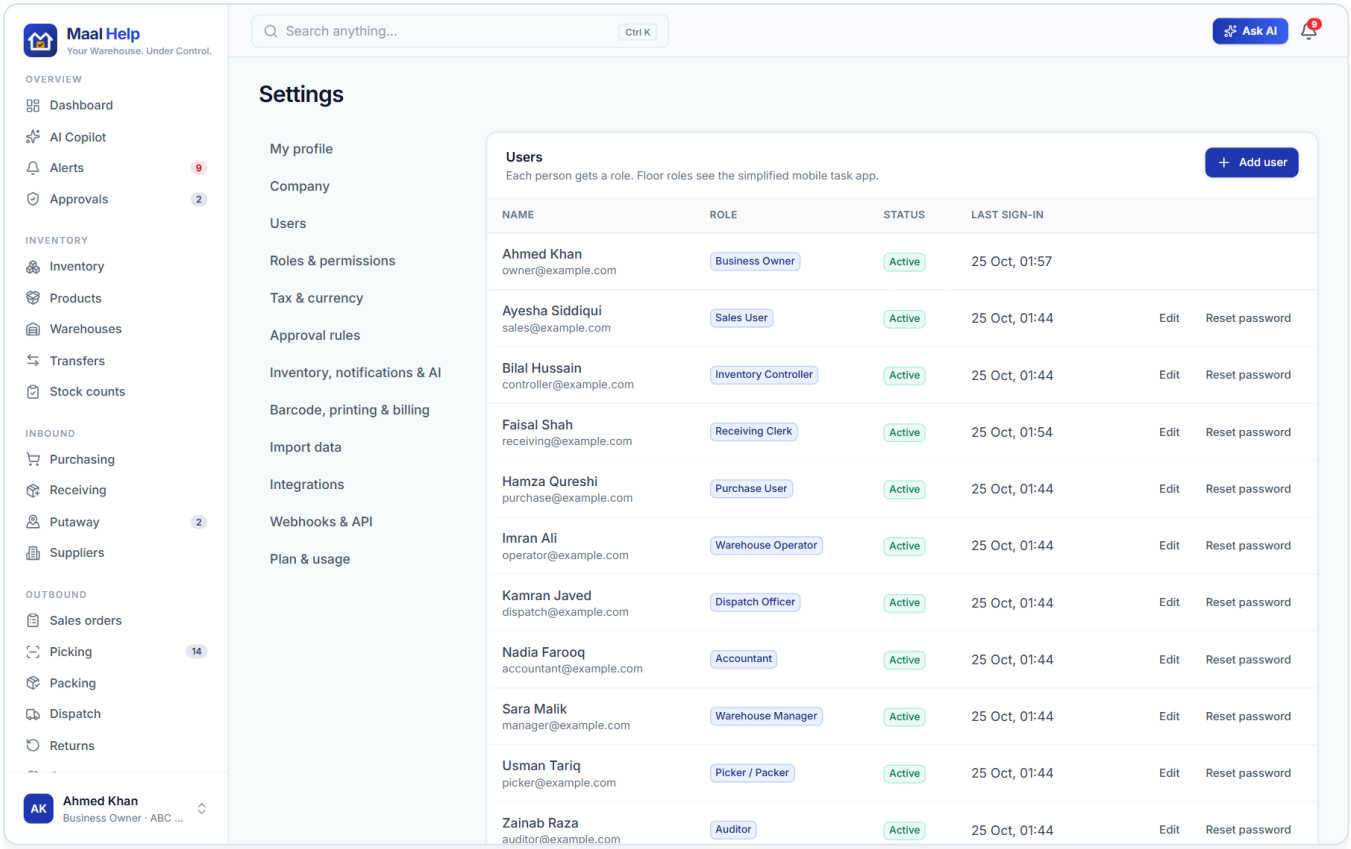


Figure 28. Users with role, status and last sign-in.

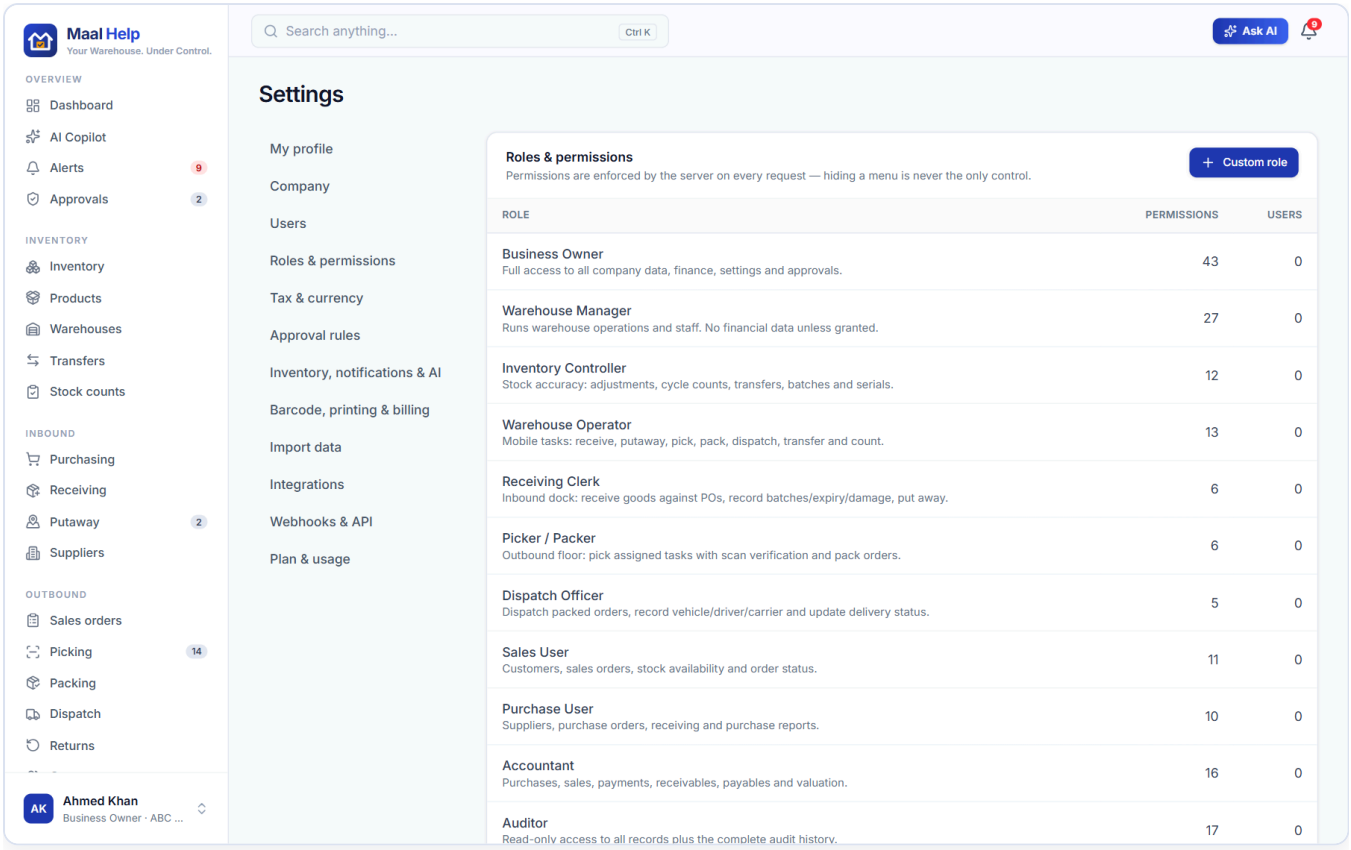


Figure 29. Roles & permissions.

1. **Settings → Users → Add user**: name, email, role and a temporary password. Share it privately.
2. **Edit** to change role or disable a user; **Reset password** issues a new temporary password.
3. **Settings → Roles & permissions → Custom role** creates a role from the permission catalogue.

> Give people the smallest role that covers their job. Finance figures are visible only to roles with the finance permission.

Approval rules

Transactions above a threshold wait for the approver role. The strictest matching rule applies.

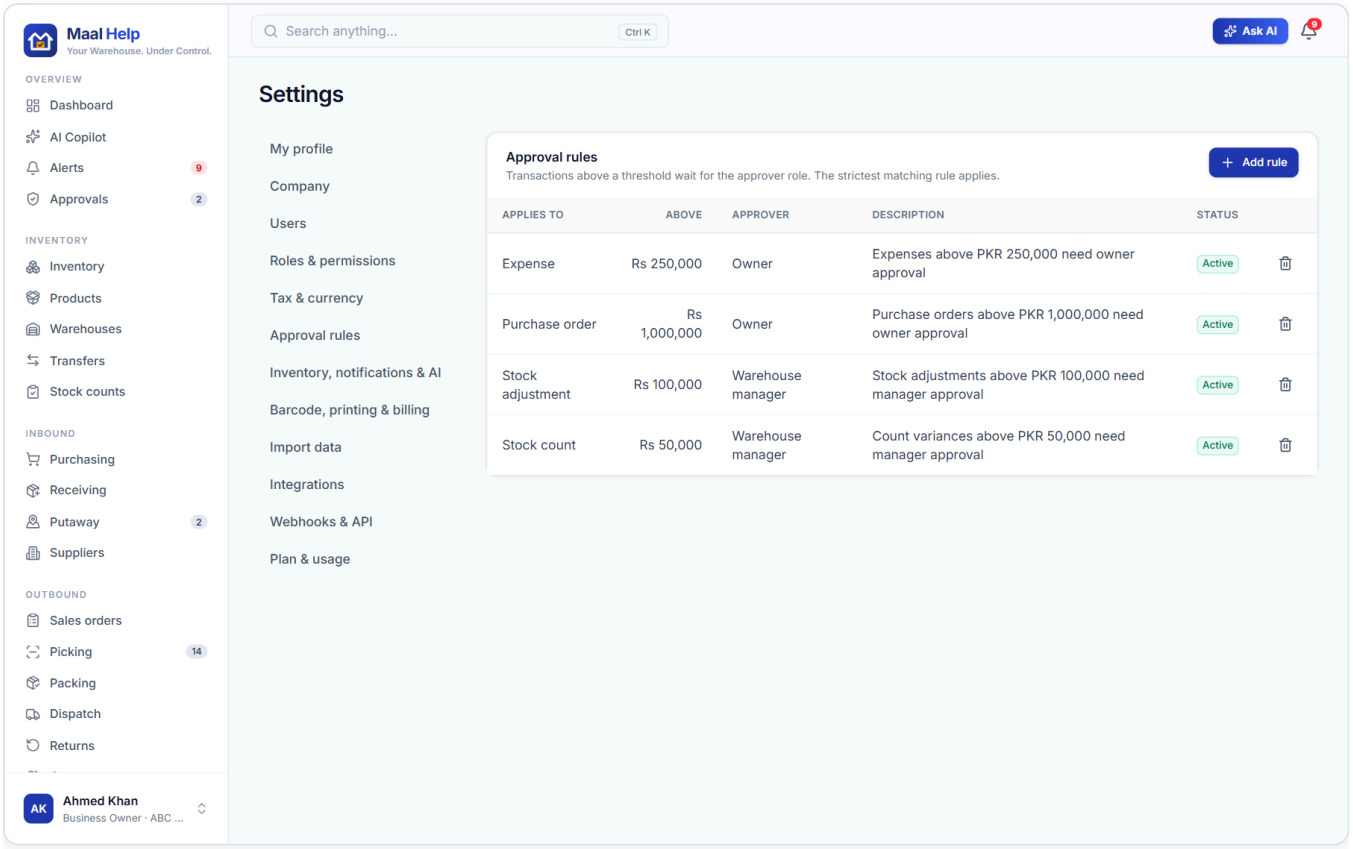


Figure 30. Approval rules by transaction type and threshold.

1. **Settings → Approval rules → Add rule**: what it applies to (adjustments, purchase orders, count variances, transfers, expenses), the amount above which it applies, and the approver role.

Inventory, notification and AI preferences

Company-wide behaviour switches.

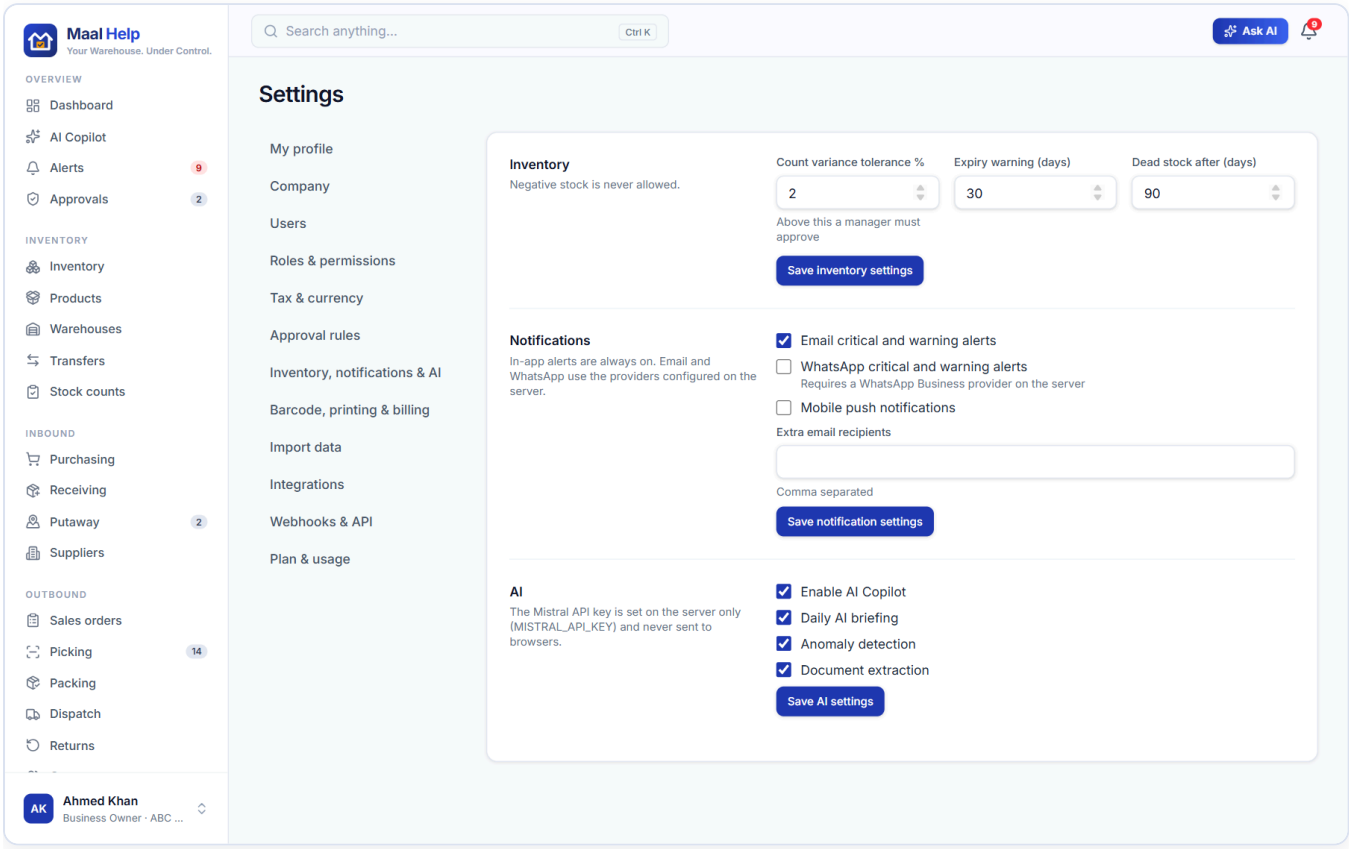


Figure 31. Inventory, notification and AI settings.

1. **Inventory**: count variance tolerance %, expiry warning days, dead-stock days.
2. **Notifications**: email and WhatsApp alerts (need providers configured on the server), extra recipients.
3. **AI**: enable Copilot, daily briefing, anomaly detection, document extraction.

> The Mistral API key is set on the server only and is never shown in the browser.

Importing data

1. Download the template · 2. Fill it in · 3. Upload to preview · 4. Fix errors or confirm. Nothing is imported until you confirm.

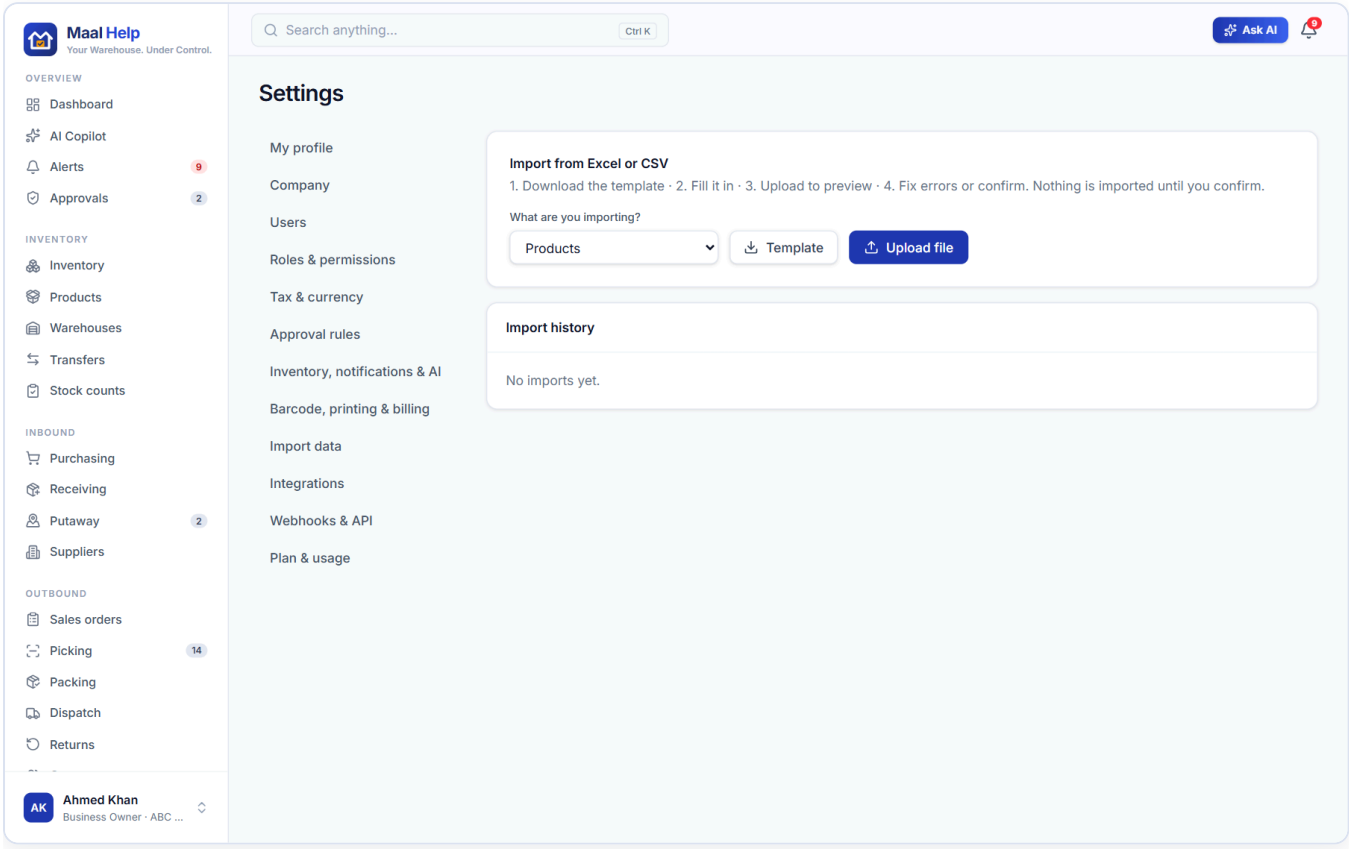


Figure 32. Import from Excel or CSV.

1. **Settings → Import data**: choose what you are importing (products, customers, suppliers, opening inventory, warehouses, locations, opening balances).
2. Download the **Template**, fill it in, then **Upload file**.
3. Review row-by-row errors, fix them in the file and upload again, or confirm to import the valid rows.

Integrations, webhooks and plan

Connections to accounting, e-commerce, shipping and messaging, plus webhooks and plan usage.

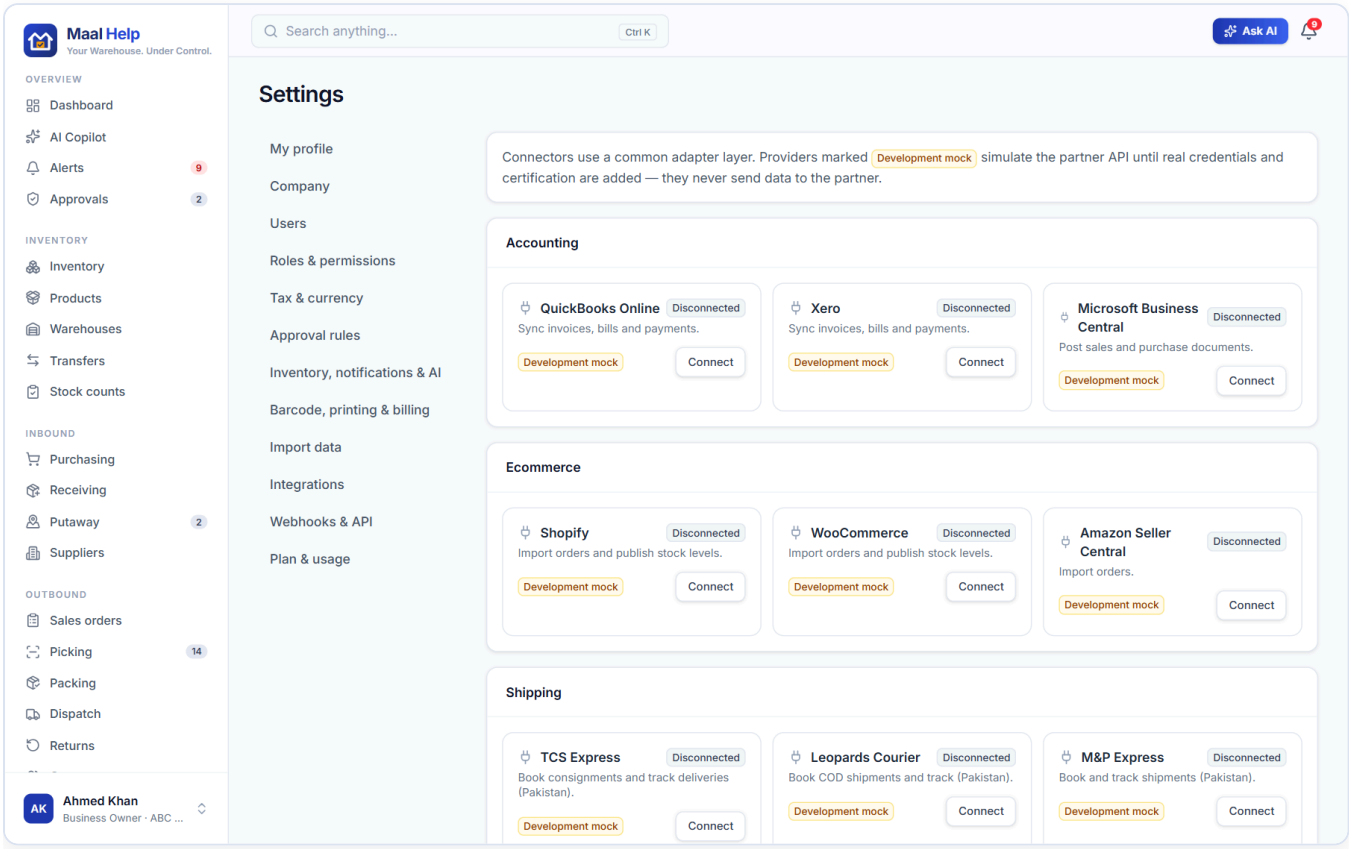


Figure 33. Integrations by category.

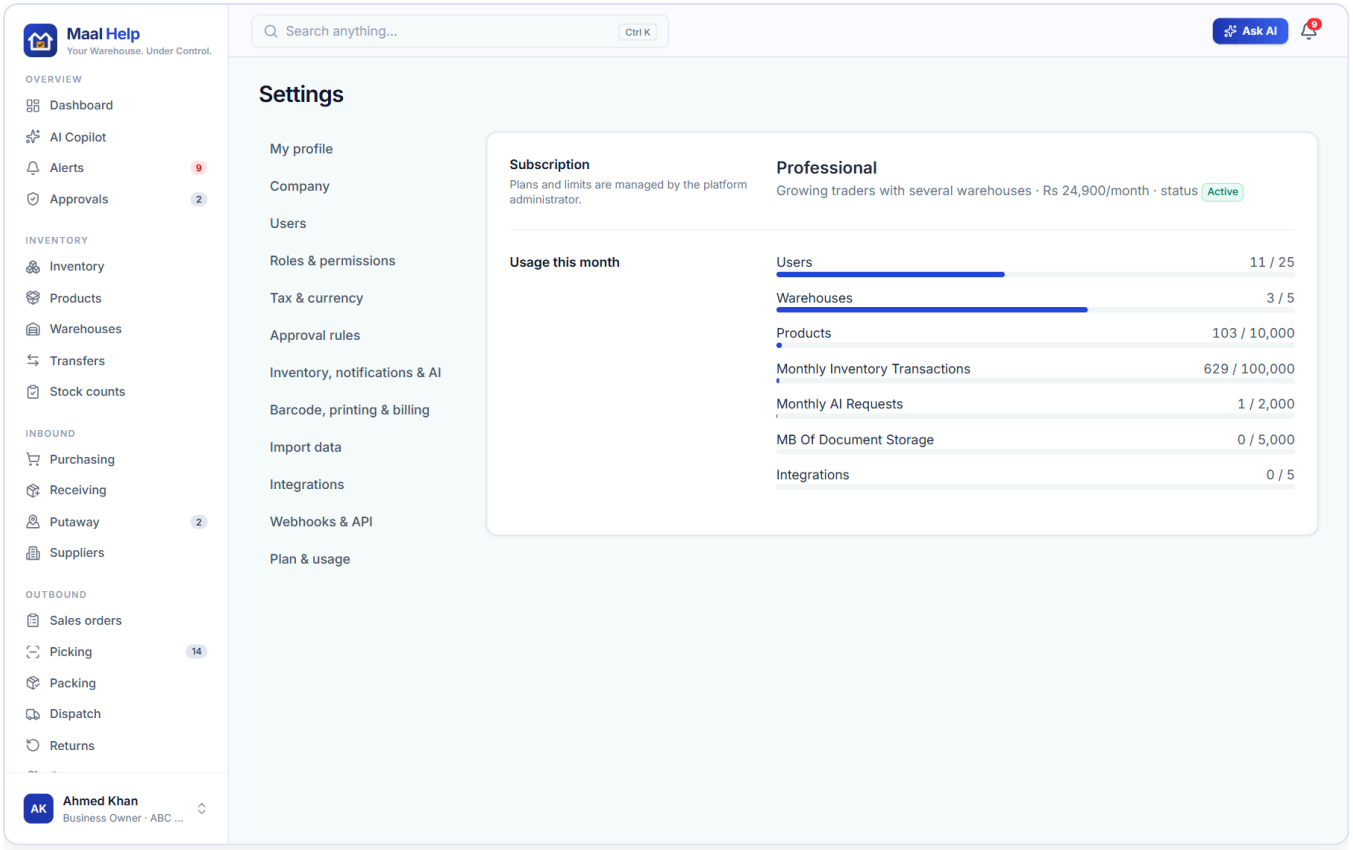


Figure 34. Plan & usage.

1. **Settings → Integrations → Connect** a provider. Credentials are encrypted at rest.
2. **Webhooks & API**: add a webhook URL and events. The signing secret is shown **once**, so store it safely.
3. **Plan & usage** shows limits (users, warehouses, SKUs, AI requests) and current use.

> In this version the integrations are **demo (mock) connectors**: they validate settings but do not exchange data with the real provider.

5 End-to-end workflows

Set up your company (first day)

1. **Settings** → **Company**: name, NTN/STRN, address, currency.
2. Create warehouses and use **Generate zone layout**.
3. Import products, suppliers, customers and opening stock (**Settings** → **Import data**).
4. Set **Approval rules** and invite your team (**Settings** → **Users**).

Morning review (10 minutes)

1. Open the Dashboard; work through *Today's intelligence*.
2. Clear **Approvals**.
3. Ask the Copilot: *What are the biggest problems in my warehouse today?*
4. Check **Billing** → **Aging** for overdue customers.

Month end

1. Run storage billing for 3PL clients.
2. Review **Profitability** by warehouse.
3. Export **Inventory valuation** and **Receivables** reports to Excel.
4. Open the **AI monthly report**.

6 Reports, notifications and exceptions

Reports and exports

Inventory valuation, Dead stock, Low stock, Sales by customer/product, Receivables, Payables, Warehouse profitability, Storage billing.

Open **Reports**, choose a report, set filters and export to Excel, CSV or PDF, or print. You see only the reports your role may view.

Notifications and alerts

Critical alerts (out of stock, warehouse ≥95% full, long-overdue customers) appear first on the dashboard and in the Alert center.

The bell at the top right lists new notifications. In-app alerts are always on; email and WhatsApp alerts depend on your company's settings.

When something is refused

Message	Meaning	What to do
Insufficient stock	Not enough *available* units at that place	Check reserved, quarantine or dock stock; choose another location or wait
Wrong location / wrong product	The scan does not match the task	Go to the right place or item and scan again
Quantity exceeds the task	More than required	Enter the task quantity
Pending approval	Above the company threshold	An approver must approve; nothing is posted yet
You don't have permission	Your role lacks the action	Ask your administrator
Credit limit exceeded	Customer balance too high	Collect payment or ask the owner

7 FAQ and troubleshooting

Frequently asked questions

Can my manager see profit and stock value?

Not by default. The Warehouse Manager role has no finance access. You can grant it with a custom role.

Does the AI change anything?

No. It reads and recommends. Suggested purchase orders open as drafts for you to review.

Why can’t I see a menu or button?

Your role does not include that permission. Ask your administrator. Permissions are checked by the server.

Can I edit or delete a posted stock movement?

No. History is permanent. Corrections are new transactions (an adjustment or reversal) with a reason, so the audit trail stays complete.

Why does the screen say stock is not available?

It may be reserved for another order, in quarantine, damaged, expired, in transit or still at the receiving dock waiting for putaway.

Is my data visible to other companies?

No. Every company’s data is isolated, and requests for another company’s records are refused.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Solution
Dashboard numbers look different from a report	Check the same warehouse and period filters are applied. Both read the same ledger.
“Missing anti-forgery header” or 403 when saving	Refresh the page. If it persists, you may lack permission for the action.
Account locked	Too many wrong passwords. Wait a few minutes or ask your administrator to reset your password.

> Still stuck? Note the screen, the record number (for example SO-10245) and the exact message, and contact your company administrator.

8 Glossary and quick reference

Quick reference

I want to...	Go to
What needs attention	**Dashboard**
Approve requests	**Approvals**
Ask a question	**AI Copilot / Ctrl+K**
Overdue customers	**Billing → Aging**
Add a user	**Settings → Users → Add user**
Thresholds	**Settings → Approval rules**
Search anything	**Ctrl + K**

Glossary

Term	Meaning
SKU	Stock-keeping unit: one product code.
GRN	Goods received note: the record of a delivery received.
PO	Purchase order to a supplier.
SO	Sales order from a customer.
Putaway	Moving received goods from the dock into a storage location.
FEFO	First-expiry-first-out: older-expiry batches are reserved and picked first.
Reserved	Units promised to a confirmed order; not available for other orders.
Quarantine	Units held for inspection; not sellable.
In transit	Units dispatched on a transfer but not yet received.
Ledger	The permanent, append-only list of every stock movement.
Wave	A group of pick tasks picked together (batch or zone).
Back-order	The part of an order that could not be reserved yet.
3PL / storage client	A business whose goods you store and bill for storage and handling.

NTN / STRN	Pakistan national tax number / sales tax registration number.
Blind count	A count where the counter does not see the expected quantity.